INHIBITING FACTORS IN THE ORAL ENGLISH PROFICIENCY OF KOREAN ENGLISH LEARNERS IN BAGUIO CITY

KRISTINE S. CASTILLO, MA-ESL
Author

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Kristine S. Castillo
kscastillo@uc-bcf.edu.ph

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A Thesis Presented to

the Faculty of the Graduate School

University of the Cordilleras

In Partial Fulfillment

of the Requirements for the Degree

MASTER OF ARTS IN ENGLISH AS A SECOND LANGUAGE

by

KRISTINE SAN GABRIEL CASTILLO

June 2025

APPROVAL SHEET

This thesis entitled INHIBITING FACTORS RELATED TO THE ORAL ENGLISH PROFICIENCY OF KOREAN ENGLISH LEARNERS IN BAGUIO CITY prepared and submitted by KRISTINE CASTILLO in partial fulfillment of the requirement for the degree MASTER OF ARTS IN ENGLISH AS A SECOND LANGUAGE, has been examined and is recommended for acceptance and approval for oral examination.

JESSIE B. MARTINEZ, MAEd
Adviser

Thesis Committee

JOSEPH B. QUINTO, Ph.D.
Member

DUREZZA M. DE JESUS-BASIL, Ph.D.
Member

ROSEMARY T. BASBAS, Ph.D.
Chairperson

PANEL OF EXAMINERS

APPROVED by the Committee on Oral Examination on _____ with a grade of _____.

ROSEMARY T. BASBAS, Ph.D.
Chairperson

JOSEPH B. QUINTO, Ph.D.
Member

DUREZZA M. DE JESUS-BASIL, Ph.D.
Member

ACCEPTED AND APPROVED in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of MASTER OF ARTS IN ENGLISH AS A SECOND LANGUAGE.

Comprehensive Examination passed on _____.

DUREZZA M. DE JESUS-BASIL, Ph.D.
Dean, College of Arts and Sciences

THESIS ABSTRACT

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7.1 Rationale/Background of the Study

The English language is important in today's competitive era as an urging tool for international communication. In addition, English proficiency is highly valued by foreign learners for academic, professional, and social success since it manifests how competent a speaker is. Language acquisition is a complex and multifaceted process, particularly in the context of second or foreign language learning. One area that has garnered significant attention is the speaking proficiency of learners, as effective communication remains a central goal in language education. For Korean learners of English, the journey to achieving a high level of speaking proficiency is accompanied by various challenges and inhibiting factors.

Thus, this study explores the level of inhibiting factors related to the oral proficiency of Korean learners in Baguio City. Consequently, the study aims to help the Korean learners improve their oral English proficiency level along with teachers, language institutions,

curriculum planners and administrators in designing lessons and instructional materials for the students.

7.2 Summary

The main goal of this study is to examine the level of inhibiting factors influencing the oral English proficiency of Korean learners in Baguio City.

Specifically, it aimed to answer the following research questions:

1. What is the current oral English proficiency level of Korean learners in Baguio City?

2. What is the level of the inhibiting factors in the oral proficiency of Korean learners along:
   a. Linguistic Factors;
   b. Schematic Factors;
   c. Cognitive Factors;
   d. Affective Factors; and
   e. Interactional Factors?

3. What is the relationship between English speaking proficiency and the inhibiting factors in improving the proficiency of Korean learners?

7.3 Findings

Based on the analysis and interpretation of data, the following are the findings of the study:

1. There is a total of 58 respondents in the study. The demographic profile of Korean learners in terms of oral English proficiency was identified. It revealed 14% of respondents belong to A1 level, 36% belong to A2 level, 38% belong to B1 level, 10% belong to B2 level, and 2% belong to C1 level.

2. The level of inhibiting factors related to the oral English proficiency are as follows:

a. Korean learners scored a high level of inhibiting factor in linguistics with a general weighted mean score of 2.55. Korean learners showed a high level of inhibition with respect to vocabulary (3.11), grammar (2.79) and colloquial expressions (2.79), and word order (2.67), while indicating a low level of inhibition in terms of poor pronunciation (2.24), inability to understand of L1's speaking (2.31) and inability to understand of L2's speaking (2.26) and speaking speed (2.28).

b. Korean learners perceived schematic factors as a low level inhibiting factor with an overall mean of 2.20. Korean learners showed a low level of inhibition with respect to lack of various topics (2.47), lack of knowledge about a topic (2.34), lack of L2 culture (1.98), and cultural differences between L1 and L2 (2.02).

c. Korean learners perceived cognitive factors as a low level inhibiting factor with an overall mean of 2.38. Korean learners showed a high level of inhibition with respect to thinking in L1 and speaking in English (2.64) and difficulty in using existing knowledge (2.97), while indicating a low level of inhibition with respect to cognitive difference between L1 and L2 (1.79), thinking too much and adults' abstract thinking process (2.28).

d. Korean learners perceived affective factors as a low level inhibiting factor with an overall mean of 1.76. Korean learners showed a low level of inhibition with respect to lack of risk taking (2.12), and anxiety while indicating a very low level of inhibition with respect to introversion, self-esteem and lack of motivation.

e. Korean learners perceived interactional factors as a low level inhibiting factor in general with a total mean score of 1.96. Korean learners showed a low level of inhibition with respect to few chances to speak with L2 speakers (2.21), being overwhelmed by proficient learners (2.09), peer's evaluation (1.91), and making mistakes (2.0), while indicating a very low level of inhibition with respect to speaking in class vs. outside of class (1.6),

speaking with L1 vs. L2 speakers (1.69), teacher's evaluation (1.69), and frequent error corrections (1.33).

3. Based on the results, English proficiency level and linguistic factors have a negative relationship, indicating that as the English proficiency level of the respondents' increases, the inhibiting linguistic factors decreases and vice versa. The same is true for cognitive, and affective factors. Overall, as English proficiency level increases, inhibiting linguistic, cognitive, and affective factors decreases and vice versa. In contrast, no significant relationship was seen between schematic and interactional factors and English proficiency level.

7.4 Conclusions

Based on the findings, the following conclusions can be drawn from this study;

1. Korean learners hold mostly an English proficiency level of A2 and B1.
2. All the inhibiting factors contribute to the low English Proficiency of Korean learners.
3. Among the inhibiting factors, linguistics has the highest significant relationship as Korean learners struggle mostly with vocabulary, grammar, word order, and colloquial expressions.

7.5 Recommendations

Based on the findings and conclusions, the researcher was aided to have the following recommendations:

1. Educators should address challenges faced by Korean learners especially the linguistic factors.

2. Educators may provide focused lessons on grammar, vocabulary, pronunciation and fluency, and contextualize the learning materials focusing on speaking. Future researchers may want to focus more on linguistic factors, extend the population with other nationalities to find any other relationships related to the field of second language learning, and elicit other inhibiting factors.

3. A bigger population for future research is recommended as the study was limited to a few academies in Baguio English School Association.

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K.S.C.

DEDICATION

To the Almighty God,
Thank You for being my constant source of strength, wisdom, and light. In moments of doubt, You carried me. In moments of weakness, You gave me courage. This work is a testament to Your unending grace in my life. Sa Ama ang kapurihan.

To my one and only daughter,
You are the reason I strive, the heart behind every effort, and the joy that keeps me going. May this achievement remind you that with faith and perseverance, anything is possible.

And lastly, to myself—
For every sleepless night, every tear held back, and every time I chose to rise instead of giving up. This is for the version of me who kept believing, even when it was hard.

Kristine

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Chapter 1

The Problem

Background of the Study

The English language is important in today's competitive era as an urgent tool for international communication. People around the world are learning the English language, and in the process of learning the language, foreign learners must acquire the four basic skills, namely listening, reading, speaking, and writing. Among the four communication skills, speaking is one of the most difficult to learn as it is categorized as a productive skill (Purba, 2018).

Moreover, English proficiency is highly valued for academic, professional, and social success in South Korea, as being proficient in speaking manifests how competent a speaker is (Lee and Choi, 2017). Since South Korea is a highly developed country, there has been considerable interest in research on the oral proficiency of Korean English learners, as well as on effective teaching and assessment strategies that can enhance their speaking skills (Yim and Kim, 2018).

Significantly, language acquisition is a complex and multifaceted process, particularly in the context of second

or foreign language learning. One area that has garnered significant attention is the speaking proficiency of learners, as effective communication remains a central goal in language education (Lee and Song, 2019). For Korean learners of English, the journey to achieving a high level of speaking proficiency is accompanied by various challenges and inhibiting factors (Lee and Choi, 2017).

Notably, South Korea's commitment to English language education is evident in its policies and initiatives that aim at fostering global communication skills. Lee and Choi (2017), as cited by Kim (2016), highlight the government's efforts to improve English education by implementing a mandatory English curriculum from early childhood to higher education levels. This initiative includes recruiting native English-speaking teachers to provide students with authentic language exposure.

The following studies have examined the impact of English language education on South Korean students. For example, Yim and Kim (2018) found that English proficiency positively influenced academic achievement and cognitive abilities. It was linked by Lee and Choi (2017) that the higher the English proficiency, the higher the scores the

students get in the college admission test, which is the most important test in entering the university.

Indeed, English proficiency has become an essential asset in the South Korean job market. Research indicates a strong correlation between English language skills and employment prospects. Park and Kim (2018) found that English proficiency significantly influenced job performance and salary levels, particularly in international companies and industries with global connections. Furthermore, English language certifications, such as TOEIC and TOEFL, serve as a measure of English language proficiency and are commonly sought after by South Korean job seekers. This can be supported by Jeon and Kang (2019), who revealed that individuals with higher English proficiency levels, as indicated by TOEIC scores, had a higher likelihood of securing employment in multinational corporations.

Aside from security for employment, English proficiency enables South Korean students and professionals to engage in international exchange programs and to study abroad. These experiences contribute to intercultural understanding and the development of global networks for future collaborations (Lee & Choi, 2017). As emphasized by

Kwon and Kim (2020), English language competence broadens South Korea's cultural influence and strengthens its soft power in the global arena. With the abovementioned significance of the English language in Korean contexts, English proficiency has a positive impact on the academic achievement, cognitive abilities, employment opportunities, and salary, cultural exchange, and international collaborations of Koreans.

Meanwhile, the ongoing controversies regarding the situational challenges of the English language have to be discussed. The importance of the English language lies heavily in the role it plays in various facets of global interactions. As mentioned by Kachru (1985), South Korea belongs to the expanding circle with its recent literature that states English is not an official or second language. Korean people speak their native language as everyday communication and transaction, while the English language is only used for international communication (Kim and Kang, 2017). For first and second-language English speakers, the English language is an essential tool for communication in everyday life. Despite the practical use of the English language, Korean people consider the English language as a mere subject in school that needs to be passed (Simpson,

2022). Koreans' perception of English has much influence on how they personally treat English in their lives, thus contributing to the poor quality of their English skills. Although English is being taught in schools for six years in middle and high school, most Korean people still do not speak English freely and confidently (Korean Herald, 2014).

According to the Korean Herald (2014), Koreans perceive English as much more than a lingua franca, marking the language as a means of status. Learners are spending a huge amount of money on English education and tutoring at many academies, especially designed for studying English. Based on the article in 2012, the cost of English Education was tallied at 6.5 trillion won in 2012 (approximately $5.5 million), exceeding the expenses for any other subject according to government data. This shows that the need of learning English is crucial in South Korea.

Additionally, Korea Times (2016) stated that South Koreans speak English at a moderate level of proficiency despite lavish spending on learning the language. Similarly, Education First (2024), an international education company based in Switzerland with the world's largest ranking of countries and regions by English skills, reported that South Korea ranked 50th among 116 countries,

which was categorized as “Moderate Proficiency”. Given the abovementioned data, English skills among Koreans remain under moderate proficiency and therefore labeled as unimproved.

Although many Korean learners strive to improve their speaking proficiency, there are several factors that can inhibit their ability to do so. The following review of related literature aims to provide an overview of these factors.

Jung and Woo (2005) found three main domains detrimental to the difficulties of Korean adult learners in communication, which include 1) Linguistic domain, 2) Schematic domain, and 3) Interactional domain. The findings suggest that a lack of linguistic and schematic knowledge is the major barrier learners encounter in communication.

In connection with the affective domain, which is one of the inhibiting factors in the oral proficiency of Korean learners, Kim (2018) identified the issue of English speaking anxiety among Korean university students and its sources using the TOEIC (Test of English for International Communication) speaking program. The study investigated the correlation between the Foreign Language Classroom Anxiety Scale and Language Anxiety in Cognitive Processes and its

impact on the students' TOEIC speaking achievement. According to the students, the program helped them to overcome English-speaking anxiety, which resulted in high test scores. Moreover, the program allowed them to be more confident communicators. Although the program was a success, the research has its limitations since the study was carried out by twenty participants, thus limiting its generalizability, suggesting that the limitations could be solved with a larger population with different levels.

In another study, Yoon (2015) explored the factors contributing to the fear of learning and using a new language among Korean English learners. As a result, the most significant factors contributing to language anxiety among Korean learners are fear of negative evaluation, communication apprehension, and test anxiety.

Moreover, Park and Lee (2014) investigated the relationship between language anxiety and English proficiency among Korean learners. According to the study, Korean learners who have higher anxiety have a lower English proficiency, and gender and English language exposure were found to be significant factors in the learners' levels of language anxiety. The study provides an

essential understanding of the relationship between English proficiency and language anxiety of Korean learners.

In another study, Kim and Kang (2017) identified the relationship between pronunciation and fluency and speaking proficiency among Korean English learners. The authors examined the separate and combined effects of accuracy and fluency on speaking proficiency and found that pronunciation accuracy and fluency were positively correlated with speaking proficiency.

Significantly, the study of Chang (2014) proved that Korean learners of the English language who engaged in face-saving behavior, such as avoiding mistakes and maintaining social harmony, tend to have lower speaking proficiency. On the contrary, the study found that Korean learners who take chances and fail in speaking had higher English proficiency. For one thing, Korean culture places a high value on face-saving, which may affect how Korean learners see and understand the process of language learning.

One of the most important concepts as far as learning a language is concerned is pronunciation. Identifying the errors committed by Korean learners was made possible with the study of Lee (2013). According to the study, the sounds

of /r/ and /l/ and the vowel sounds /i/ and /I/ are the most common errors produced by the respondents. Notably, the influence of their native language pronunciation, lack of exposure to native English speakers, and lack of attention to pronunciation in English classes contributed to the said errors.

As stated by Simpson (2022), there are several reasons why English proficiency in Korea is rather low. One possible reason can be associated with the Korean Educational system that emphasizes memorization more than critical thinking. In line with this, Kim and Lee (2015) explored the impact of the Korean education system on Korean learners' English speaking proficiency. According to the study, the Korean education system gives more importance to reading and writing skills rather than speaking and listening skills. The lack of opportunities for students to practice speaking English in a natural setting was identified as a major factor affecting their speaking proficiency. The study also found that students' attitudes toward learning English, their motivation, and their experiences with English language teachers were significant factors in their speaking proficiency.

Another key point is the study conducted by Jeon (2009), which described how Korean students often become silent learners in classrooms that are dominated by grammar translation and test preparation approaches. Notably, Jeon (2009) made use of the term "Mute English" phenomenon in language acquisition. The term mute English emerged informally in media and educational forums. Accordingly, mute English describes the condition where learners possess strong receptive skills but lack the ability to use in communication. As a result, many Korean learners remain unable to express themselves orally despite years of formal English education.

The needs of English in modernization and globalization led the study of English in a more enormous effort. Concerning meeting this demand, an increasing number of L2 students are sent abroad to study English. The Philippines is one of the countries that South Korean learners consider a haven, as far as learning the English language is concerned. According to the British Council, as cited by Manila Bulletin (2020), the Philippines is recognized globally as one of the largest English-speaking nations, citing the influx of foreign students as a key factor in the quality of ESL programs being offered. This

resulted in the establishment of English schools around the country, where Baguio English Schools are considered among the best ESL schools in the country. Baguio English schools have been so popular among many students all over Asia, not only because of their geographical setting, but also because they have proven their efficacy when teaching English (AnJ, 2021). This showcases that ESL Filipino teachers hold a privilege in helping Korean students to learn English.

Consequently, the study aims to help the Korean learners improve their oral English proficiency level. Additionally, the study aims to help ESL teachers, along with language institutions, curriculum planners, and administrators, in designing lessons and instructional materials for the students.

For Korean learners, developing fluency and accuracy in speaking English can be particularly challenging due to several inhibiting factors, as language acquisition is a complex process that involves various skills, including speaking proficiency. This study on inhibiting factors in speaking proficiency is significant for Korean learners as it allows them to identify and address specific challenges they face. By understanding the factors hindering their

speaking skills, learners may develop targeted strategies to overcome these obstacles.

English as a second language (ESL) teachers play a pivotal role in guiding and supporting Korean learners in their quest to improve their speaking proficiency. Studying inhibiting factors provides valuable insights to teachers, enabling them to adapt their teaching methods and strategies to address specific challenges faced by Korean learners. By understanding common barriers, such as cultural differences, grammar intricacies, or limited exposure to authentic English environments, teachers may tailor their instruction to facilitate better speaking outcomes. Such knowledge empowers teachers to design more effective lessons, create learner-centered environments, and provide targeted feedback to foster speaking development.

ESL curriculum planners are responsible for designing and updating language programs to meet the needs of Korean learners. Studying inhibiting factors in speaking proficiency informs curriculum planners about the specific areas that require attention and improvement. It allows for the integration of appropriate instructional materials, teaching methodologies, and assessment tools to address the

identified challenges. By aligning curriculum goals with the findings of such studies, curriculum planners may ensure that Korean learners receive comprehensive and relevant instruction, leading to enhanced speaking proficiency outcomes.

ESL administrators will benefit from the study as they strive to provide high-quality language education. A deep understanding of these factors enables institutions to develop more effective support mechanisms and resources for learners.

For future ESL researchers, this study aims to contribute to the body of knowledge in second language acquisition, especially for Korean learners. The cumulative research allows for the identification of trends and patterns, facilitating the development of comprehensive theoretical frameworks. This knowledge may guide future researchers, leading to the creation of more effective language learning approaches and the advancement of the field.

Theoretical/Conceptual Framework

This section discussed the difficulty encountered by Korean English learners in improving their oral proficiency skills along with linguistic, schematic, cognitive,

affective, and interactional inhibiting factors. Understanding the theoretical basis of speaking proficiency is essential for effective language teaching, learning, and assessment.

Universal Grammar Theory

One of the most controversial theories when it comes to grammar learning is the universal grammar theory by Noam Chomsky in 1986. According to this theory, there are sets of grammatical rules and structures imprinted in the human brain. This explains why children can learn grammar without formal teaching. Accordingly, Chomsky reiterates that universal grammar is not a grammar, but rather a theory of grammars, a kind of metatheory for grammar. Components that are considered universal include the notion that words can be classified into different groups, such as nouns or verbs, and that sentences follow a particular structure. Sentence structure may be different between languages, but each language has a different kind of framework. This theory justifies the claim that linguistic factors related to the oral English proficiency of Korean learners, such as grammar, must be reorganized and reconstructed to meet the requirements of the target language.

Input Hypothesis

Vocabulary retention is one of the crucial aspects when it comes to second language acquisition. It is difficult to remember words and phrases, which is why second language learners tend to memorize words and phrases endlessly. On the contrary, this is not the case according to the Input Hypothesis. In conformity with the Input Hypothesis (Krashen, 1982), language learners do not need grammar drills or endless vocabulary lists as much as they need to focus on interacting using the language that they can understand. Based on the hypothesis, comprehensible input i+1 is the key to acquiring a language naturally. In this matter of comprehensible input, "i" pertains to the learner's current level, and +1 is the input that is a little above their current level of understanding. Therefore, when a learner knows basic English sentences like "I go to school", and they hear or read, "I go to school every morning," they can understand it with context, and in the process, they can learn new words like every and morning. In connection with Korean English learners, this hypothesis suggests that learners can truly acquire a language not by memorizing rules, but by being exposed to language in a real context.

Interlanguage Theory

Learning a new language can be understood through Interlanguage Theory, proposed by Larry Selinker in 1972. According to this theory, when learners try to use a new language, they create their unique linguistic system which links somewhere between their first language and the target language. This transition is known as interlanguage.

Interlanguage is unique and evolving. It changes as learners gain more experience with the second language. It reflects their ongoing efforts to master the new language. Additionally, a person's first language significantly influences their interlanguage. Learners may initially replace or omit certain grammatical structures if it is not applicable in their first language. Errors made by learners while trying to use the language are not random but systematic, based on the learner's developmental understanding of the target language. These errors could be fossilized, and they could change or not depending on the effort of learners in mastering the target language.

Interlanguage theory plays a vital role in understanding how people learn a second language. The theory supports the fact that learners often rely on their first language as a foundation as they learn and adjust to

build their language skills gradually. As for Korean English learners, they often struggle with pronunciation as these sounds do not exist in their first language, which is Hangeul. Grammatical differences can also lead to errors, as some grammatical structures of Hangeul are not present in the target language and vice versa. Moreover, Korean learners may directly translate words from their first language to the target language, leading to errors.

Communicative Competence Theory

One of the key theories in language learning is communicative competence, which was first proposed by Dell Hymes in 1972. According to the theory, a learner must use a language in real-life circumstances to be able to create meaningful conversations, and that learning a language is not about mastering the rules, but understanding how to communicate well.

Moreover, Canal and Swain (1980) built their own version of communicative competence based on Hymes' theory. There are four key components of communicative competence, namely grammatical, sociolinguistic, discourse, and strategic competencies. The first competence consists of knowledge of grammar and vocabulary. A learner must know how to construct sentences that are grammatically correct.

Second is sociolinguistic competence, which emphasizes the ability to use a language appropriately in various social contexts. Incorporating culture is important in this aspect, as someone cannot learn a language without learning their culture. Third is discourse competence, which involves the ability to relate sentences to create comprehensible and meaningful conversations. A learner must know how to organize his or her thoughts rationally in a certain context, including paraphrasing, turn-taking, and using gestures to convey what the speaker is trying to say. Fourth is the strategic competence, which is the ability to overcome communication difficulties to achieve the desired communication goals. These barriers include anxiety, fear of making mistakes, and lack of confidence when speaking English. The communicative competence theory supports the argument that Korean English learners must possess the four competencies to achieve the desired communication goals. In the view of Korean education, which emphasizes merely memorization, taking the theory into consideration might shed light on the unimproved speaking proficiency of Koreans.

Audio-Lingual Approach

The process of acquiring a new language can be explained by Frederic Skinner's Audio-Lingual Approach, which focuses mainly on listening and speaking (Skinner, 1957). This approach is deeply seated in behaviorism, which supports the idea that people learn a new language by establishing a habit formation that could be achieved through repetition, imitation, and reinforcement. Additionally, as mentioned by Larsen-Freeman and Anderson (2011), the main concept of the approach is that language learning is a habit-forming process that is best attained through repetition and practice.

Furthermore, teachers play a vital role in leading an Audio-lingual approach. This situation happens when the teachers take a mimicking role by saying the words, then the students must repeat, doing sentences drill, and practicing dialogues many times. At this point, the teacher is like a model, and the students are expected to learn by copying the teacher. Additionally, teachers must encourage and praise the students when the students say words correctly, and the teachers must correct the students when the students make mistakes to avoid fossilization. In this way, learners can remember the correct structure and form

and build good habits (Fries, 1945). The audio-lingual approach is helpful in the context of Korean English learners in improving the learners' speaking proficiency by mimicking the correct pronunciation from English language teachers. Moreover, with repetition and reinforcement, the approach will lessen the fossilization of errors, leading to improved speaking skills.

Psycholinguistic Approaches to Speaking

Psycholinguistic approaches to speaking focus on how the brain processes language production, perception, and acquisition (Kennison et al., 2014). More importantly, it focuses on the application of the actual language and communication, which is necessary in applying various methods that allow learners to easily understand a language (Purba, 2018).

Psycholinguistic approaches to speaking examine the cognitive processes and linguistic mechanisms involved in the production of spoken language. These approaches explore the mental steps involved in producing speech, from forming ideas to saying words (Gass & Selinker, 2020).

Based on psycholinguistics, there are three main stages. The first one is speech production, which follows three stages from conceptualization to formulation and

articulation. The conceptualization stage is where ideas are formed, next is formulation, where the brain organizes the grammar and vocabulary to form a sentence, and finally is articulation, where the brain sends a signal to the mouth and vocal cords to produce the speech sounds. The second stage is the mental lexicon, where the brain retrieves the right word from the mental dictionary, where words and their meanings, sounds, and grammatical rules are stored. The third stage is error monitoring, where the brain continuously checks for errors while speaking.

In conversation, interlocutors take turns as speakers and listeners simultaneously. In doing so, speakers and listeners undergo the process of comprehension while listening and then take the role of the speaker to respond with a new message. Generally, the response in conversation takes place in the middle of an incoming turn. As speaking usually happens in conversation, taking part in interaction, including rapid prediction, is part of the speaking construct. Therefore, prediction plays an important role in language production, comprehension, and dialogue (Pickering & Garrod, 2013). In the case of Korean learners, the third stage, which is error monitoring, is being left out as learners focus only on reading and

solving grammar mistakes. Psycholinguistic approaches to speaking could help Korean learners in enhancing the cognitive barriers to speaking by engaging in meaningful conversation.

Skill Acquisition Theory in Second Language Learning

There are several theories that have been devised based on models of skill attainment in cognitive psychology concerning second language acquisition. As initially proposed by Fitts and Posner (1967), Skill Acquisition Theory is a prominent framework that explains the process of acquiring new skills, including the stages of skill acquisition and the role of feedback and practice. Moreover, Robert DeKeyser (2007) states that Skill Acquisition Theory explains how individuals acquire and develop new skills from novice to advanced level, which includes both cognitive and psychomotor skills. This theory is based on the Adaptive Control of Thought Model, which claims that adults start learning something through explicit procedures and subsequent sufficient practice and exposure to implicit processes (Anderson, 1982). According to Chapelle (2009), Skill Acquisition Theory is an umbrella of general human learning, and learning a second language is like learning any other skill.

Skill acquisition progresses through distinct stages, namely cognitive, associative, and autonomous. In the cognitive stage, learners focus on understanding the skill's requirements and developing mental representations. Learners acquire declarative knowledge about the skill and engage in conscious processing to perform the task. As learners progress to the associative stage, their performance becomes more efficient and coordinated. Practice plays a critical role in this stage, allowing learners to refine motor patterns and improve accuracy. Finally, in the autonomous stage, skills become automatic, requiring minimal conscious effort. In the second language acquisition context, this stage involves applying language rules and structures in communicative contexts, leading to increased accuracy and fluency (Taie, 2014). Taking the inhibiting factors related to the oral proficiency of Korean learners, the theory might shed light, as it emphasizes the role of practice, which is essential in acquiring a new skill.

Interactionist Theory in Second Language Acquisition

The Interactionist Theory by Michael Long (1996) emphasizes the importance of social interaction in learning a language, as the theory deeply emphasizes the importance

of social interaction in shaping second language acquisition. According to Long (1996), language development happens through meaningful interactions with others, and learners acquire a language best when use to communicate in real-life situations.

The first key idea of interactionist theory is to focus on interaction. It argues that language acquisition is facilitated through meaningful and authentic interactions that allow learners to negotiate meanings and engage in communication. The second key idea is negotiation of meaning. According to this theory, the negotiation happens when learners and educators go hand in hand in clarifying and modifying learners' thoughts to achieve mutual understanding, as negotiation of meaning contributes to both comprehension and learning. Specifically, learners receive feedback, adjust their utterances, and refine their communicative skills.

The third idea is modified output as Long suggests, "Modified output offers learners a kind of feedback that they cannot provide for themselves, and that is rarely provided in any other way" (Long, 1996, p. 445). In relevance to Korean learners, output should be modified and adjusted by educators to facilitate language development,

as these modifications serve as an input that provides learners with examples of more advanced and accurate language usage, helping them internalize correct language patterns and improve their proficiency.

The fourth idea is noticing and focusing on form. Long (1996) argues that Korean learners need to actively notice and pay attention to specific linguistic features within meaningful interactions. Long explains, "Attention to form should not be excluded from the communicative curriculum but incorporated within it" (Long, 1996, p. 448). This focus on form helps learners become more aware of the target language's grammar, vocabulary, and pronunciation, leading to improved accuracy and fluency.

Affective Domain of Second Language Acquisition

Hoque (2017) provides an introduction to the affective domain in second language acquisition (SLA). These factors, namely anxiety, empathy, and motivation, are the emotional side of human behavior in the second language learning process. These affective factors play a crucial role in learners' engagement, language learning processes, and ultimately, their language learning outcomes. Anxiety pertains to feelings of uneasiness, self-doubt, uncertainty, apprehension, or worry. Anxiety might be

categorized as momentary or situational level. State anxiety is experienced in relation to a particular event. Foreign language anxiety focuses more on the situational nature of state anxiety, such as communication apprehension, fear of negative evaluation, and test anxiety over academic evaluation.

Empathy is the ability to see one's own personality in the personality of another to be able to understand him or her. Speaking is a means of empathizing, and to be able to communicate effectively, one must understand other people's affective and cognitive states.

Motivation is frequently associated with the inner drive that makes a person do a particular action. With proper motivation, a second language learner like Koreans would seem to be successful. There are five types of motivation. Firstly, in instrumental motivation, learners are prompted for functional purposes such as passing an examination, getting a better job, accomplishing a task, and so on. Secondly, in integrative motivation, learners are motivated because they wish to integrate themselves into people and culture and to be part of society. Thirdly, in resultative motivation, the result of learning may become more motivated or unmotivated. Lastly, in intrinsic

motivation, learners' curiosity and interest are involved. There is no reward except for the sake of satisfying one's learning and well-being. Last is Extrinsic Motivation. This involves an anticipation of rewards such as money, prizes, grades, and even certain types of positive feedback. Understanding the motivation of learners comparable to Koreans in acquiring a second language is crucial, especially for long-term retention.

Social Interactionist Theory

One of the most well-known theorists when it comes to social interaction in language acquisition is the Social Interactionist Theory, developed by Lev Vygotsky in 1978 and later expanded by Jerome Bruner in 1983. The theory emphasizes the role of social and guided interaction in learning a language and proposes that learners can only learn a new language through social interaction with adults and other children (Vygotsky, 1978). This theory could be helpful when learners, particularly Korean English learners, engage in meaningful conversations such as interactions with teachers, parents, or peers who are knowledgeable in the target language.

Correspondingly, Vygotsky (1978) introduced the Zone of Proximal Development, which explains the gap between

what a child can do and what the child achieves with guidance from a more knowledgeable other. The more knowledgeable other is someone with a higher level who can facilitate learning. In the same way, teachers and peers can help Korean learners move from basic understanding to a more advanced level by guiding the learners until they can speak confidently and fluently.

Furthermore, Bruner (1983) introduced the idea of scaffolding, where learners are given support when learning a new concept and gradually lessen this support as the Korean learners develop their skills. For instance, a teacher may help a student speak a sentence in English, and as the student practices and gains confidence, the teacher lessens the support.

Critical Period Hypothesis

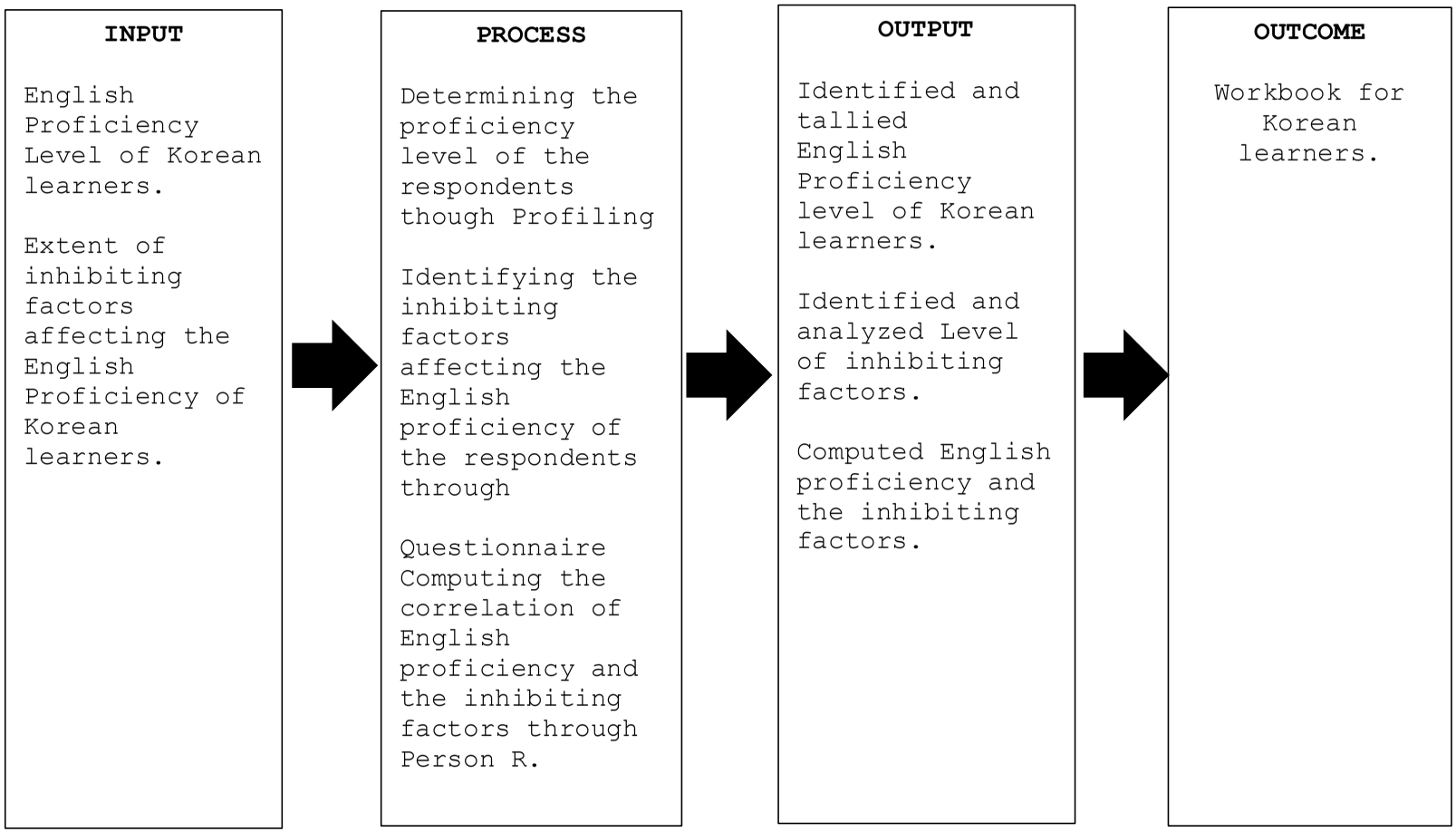
The critical period hypothesis proposed by Lenneberg in 1967 has made a great contribution in explaining why acquiring a new language can be influenced by a limited period of time. The hypothesis states that learning a second language can be acquired easily when someone is young. The hypothesis claims that after this critical period, the brain becomes less flexible in adapting to new

languages, making it more difficult to acquire a new language.

The hypothesis is based on the idea that the human brain has a natural ability to acquire languages during early childhood. After this period, around the age of 12 – 14, the brain becomes less capable of fully learning a new language, though this does not mean that adults cannot learn a second language. The Critical Period Hypothesis highlights the importance of timing in language acquisition. In the case of Korean learners, they start learning the language in middle school to high school, which is beyond the critical period. On the other hand, while younger learners generally have an advantage, learners beyond this time frame can still achieve success through dedication and the right methods. Understanding this theory helps educators design effective language learning programs for all ages.

Figure 1

Research Paradigm



Statement of the Problem

The main goal of this study is to examine the level of factors influencing the Oral English Proficiency of Korean learners in Baguio City.

Specifically, it aimed to answer the following research questions:

1. What is the current oral English proficiency level of Korean learners in Baguio City?

2. What is the level of the inhibiting factors in the oral proficiency of Korean learners along:

    a. Linguistic Factors;

    b. Schematic Factors;

    c. Cognitive Factors;

    d. Affective Factors; and

    e. Interactional Factors?

3. What is the relationship between English speaking proficiency and the inhibiting factors in improving the proficiency of Korean learners?

Ho: There is no significant relationship between the oral English Proficiency and the inhibiting factors.

Chapter 2

Design and Methodology

This chapter presents the design and methodology applicable to the study. The design of a study serves as the blueprint that guides the research process and ensures the collection of relevant and reliable data. Similarly, the methodology encompasses the systematic framework of methods and techniques used to address the research questions at hand.

Research Design and Methodology

This study followed a correlational research design, which investigates the relationship of two or more variables (Bhandari, 2023). In this study, the relationship between the oral proficiency of Korean learners and the level of inhibiting factors along linguistic, schematic, cognitive, affective, and international factors is examined.

Population and Locale of the Study

This research was conducted in two particular academies in Baguio City, Philippines. The selection is based on the Baguio English School Association (BESA), which is the umbrella organization of nine international English schools located in the northern region of the

Philippines. However, only two academies agreed to allow the researcher to conduct the study due to the privacy policy of their students, and some academies do not have Korean students at the time of data gathering. The respondents' proficiency levels are identified as part of their entry requirement following the Common European Framework of Reference (CEFR) for language levels.

The two academies are as follows: HELP Academy caters to students from South Korea, Vietnam, Taiwan, China, Japan, and Saudi Arabia. It has been in operation for 23 years, which makes it the oldest and most trusted English language institute in the Philippines. WALES Academy caters to students from Japan, Taiwan, Vietnam, South Korea, China, the Middle East, and Mongolia. Academy 2 believes that a globally competitive person needs an understanding of other cultures. Not only studying in an academy but also interacting with other nationalities outside lets you improve your English skills faster. This also encourages students to speak English all the time without imposing an English-only policy (EOP).

The participants consisted of 58 Korean English learners, 48 were from HELP Academy and 10 were from WALES Academy, respectively. Purposive sampling was used as the

population was predefined due to the objective of the research (Nikolopoulou, 2022). The criteria for selection include nationality, oral English proficiency level, and willingness to participate.

Data Gathering Tools

To answer the first problem, the researcher acquired the respondents' proficiency levels based on their proficiency upon entry to the academy. Students' levels are based on the Common European Framework of Reference (CEFR) for Languages. Accordingly, there are six language proficiency levels, namely Level A1 (Beginner), Level A2 (Pre-intermediate), Level B1 (Intermediate), Level B2 (Upper Intermediate), Level C1 (Advanced), and Level C2 (Mastery).

Learners at A1 (Beginner) can communicate using familiar everyday expressions and very basic phrases; A2 (Pre-Intermediate) learners can interact in simple and direct exchanges of information and can describe things around them and things they need; B1 (Intermediate) learners can communicate in most situations whilst travelling in an English-speaking area; B2 (Upper-Intermediate) learners can understand the main ideas of complex texts and they can interact with some fluency and

communicate easily; C1 (Advanced) learners can interact and express themselves fluently and spontaneously and use language flexibly and effectively in social, academic and professional situations; C2 (Mastery) learners can easily understand almost everything they hear or read, and they can express themselves fluently and spontaneously with precision in complex situations (Benjamine, 2023).

To answer the second problem, the researcher adopted a survey instrument from the study of Jung and Oh (2005), which consisted of 33 closed-ended questions. The students assessed themselves using a four-point scale ranging from strongly agree to strongly disagree. Moreover, there are five major factors included in the survey questionnaire: 1) linguistic, 2) schematic, 3) cognitive, 4) affective, and 5) interactional factors. Since the instrument was transcribed in the Korean language, it was translated and validated by two Korean transcriptionists who are proficient in the English language. A back translation from English to the Korean language was done for content validity by a Korean who is an English teacher in Korea.

Table 1 shows the description of the survey instrument.

Table 1

Categories of the Inhibiting Factors (Jung and Oh, 2005)

Inhibiting Factors	Items	Components
a. Linguistic	1	Lack of grammar
	2	Word order
	3	Lack of vocabulary
	4	Lack of colloquial expressions
	5	Poor pronunciation
	6	L2 speakers do not understand L1's
	7	speaking
	8	L1 speakers do not understand L2's
		speaking
		Speaking speed
b. Schematic	9	Lack of various
	10	Lack of knowledge about a topic
	11	Lack of second language culture
	12	Culture differences between L1 and L2
c. Cognitive	13	Thinking in L1 and speaking in L2
	14	Cognitive difference between L1 and
	15	L2
	16	Difficulty in using existing
	17	knowledge
		Thinking too much
		Adults' abstract thinking process
d. Affective	18	Introversion
	19	Lack of risk taking
	20	Anxiety
	21	Self-esteem
	22	Lack of motivation
e. Interactional	23	Few chances to speak with L2 speakers
	24	Speaking in class vs. out of class
	25	Speaking with L1 vs. L2 speakers
	26	Being overwhelmed by proficient
	27	learners
	28	Teacher's evaluation
	29	Peer's evaluation
	30	Making mistakes
		Frequent error corrections
f. Others	31	Lack of time and money
	32	Problems in the educational system
	33	Lack of early English education

Below shows the interpretation of levels.

Statistical Limit	Qualitative Description	Level	Interpretation
3.25 – 4.00	Strongly Agree	Very High	This indicates total agreement with the statement without reservations
2.50 – 3.24	Agree	High	This indicated general agreement with the statement, but with a little reservation.
1.75 – 2.49	Disagree	Low	This indicates not to intense disagreement with the statement.
1.00 – 1.74	Strongly Disagree	Very Low	This indicates an intense disagreement with the sentence.

To answer the third question, the researcher used correlation ration to determine the relationship between oral English proficiency and the levels of the inhibiting factors.

Data Gathering Procedures

The researcher sent consent letters together with the survey instrument to the Baguio English School Association's administrators, allowing the participation of Korean students in the study. The administrators of each academy administered the survey since the students have different class schedules, and administering it at one time is impossible. After a week of administering the survey

tool, the administrators contacted the researcher to retrieve the survey.

Treatment of Data

The following statistical tools were used by the researcher to analyze and interpret the data:

Profiling

The data was gathered from each academy and categorized depending on their English Proficiency levels.

Weighted Mean

This was used to interpret the level of the inhibiting factors in the speaking proficiency of Korean learners.

Correlation Ratio and Person R

This was used to determine the relationship between English Proficiency and the levels of the inhibiting factors.

Chapter 3

Presentation, Analysis and Interpretation of Data

This chapter presents and discusses the findings of data gathered on the current English proficiency level of Korean learners, the level of the inhibiting factors in the oral proficiency of Korean learners, and the relationship between English speaking proficiency and the inhibiting factors in improving the proficiency of Korean learners.

The Current Oral English Proficiency Level of Korean Learners

The first problem answered is the current oral English proficiency level of Korean learners. The number of students with their corresponding proficiency level is shown in Table 2.

Table 2 shows the demographic profile of Korean learners in terms of proficiency level.

Table 2

Demographic Profile of Korean Learners in Terms of Oral Proficiency Level

Proficiency Level	Number of Students	Percentage
A1	8	14%
A2	21	36%
B1	22	38%
B2	6	10%
C1	1	2%
C2	0	0
Total	**58**	

Table 2 reveals that the B1 level had the highest percentage. Meanwhile, A1, A2, B2, and C1 levels had the lowest number of students, and no respondent belonged to the C2 level. Based on CEFR, the respondents who belong to the A2 level can interact in simple and direct exchanges of communication. A2 learners can understand sentences and use expressions related to basic personal and family information, shopping, leisure, and employment. A2 learners can exchange information on familiar and routine matters directly related to them. However, A2 learners struggle with spontaneous conversation due to limited vocabulary and phrases.

Additionally, those who belong to B1 can communicate in most situations while travelling in an English-speaking country. B1 learners can deal with situations likely to arise while travelling where English is needed. B1 learners can produce simple connected inputs on topics that are familiar or of personal interest. B1 learners can describe experiences and events and briefly give reasons and explanations for opinions and plans. On the other hand, B1 learners still make errors, especially with colloquial expressions.

Meanwhile, there are a few learners in levels B2 and C1, as these levels are higher levels of English proficiency. Levels B2 and C1 show that learners can interact freely with fluency, and they can use the language effectively in various social contexts. Unfortunately, there are no learners in C2 as this is the highest level with mastery of the language.

The findings of this study corroborate the discovery of the Education First English Proficiency Index in 2025, which states that the English proficiency of Korean learners is at moderate proficiency. According to Education First (2025), moderate English proficiency means that learners can handle basic communication in English in familiar situations. However, learners lack the fluency and accuracy needed for a professional environment. Additionally, based on the data from 2007 to 2025 of Education First, they found that the English proficiency of Koreans remained stagnant, which implies that their levels did not improve.

The unimproved oral English proficiency of Korean learners could be explained by the study of Jeon (2009). The study investigated the stagnancy and minimal improvement of oral English proficiency of Korean learners.

The study linked the “Mute English” phenomenon, wherein the Korean learners can read and write English but struggle to speak well. Moreover, the study identified the causes contributing to Korea’s mute English problem, such as test-oriented curricula, large class sizes, and the teachers’ reliance on grammar translation approaches. As a result, Korean learners foster a learning for a test mindset and limit communicative competence. As supported by Hymes’ communicative theory (1972), a learner must use a language in a real-life context to communicate well.

Similar results were reported with the study conducted by Simpson (2022), who revealed that the majority of Korean learners belong to a low English level, typically A2 and B1, which implies that both educational and practical aspects in terms of instruction, curriculum design, and communication outcomes are not effective. Furthermore, the Korean educational system emphasizes memorization more than application in real life, giving more importance to reading and writing skills rather than speaking and listening skills. As supported by Interactionist Theory (Long 1996), language development happens through meaningful interactions, and language is best learned when it is used to communicate in real-life situations.

In conclusion, the stagnation of oral English proficiency among Korean learners is a result of pedagogical limitations where learners accumulate passive knowledge of the language without gaining competence in communication skills to use in real-life situations. This means that until the educational instruction focus shifts from testing to communication, the stagnancy is likely to be retained.

The Level of Inhibiting Factors in the Oral Proficiency of Korean learners

The second problem focused the level of inhibiting factors in the oral proficiency of Korean learners along linguistic, schematic, cognitive, affective, and interactional factors. Table 3 shows the mean score and level garnered in linguistic factors.

Linguistics Factors

As shown in Table 3, Korean learners scored a high level of inhibiting factor in linguistics with a general weighted mean score of 2.55. Korean learners showed a high level of inhibition concerning vocabulary (3.11), grammar (2.79) and colloquial expressions (2.79), and word order (2.67), while indicating a low level of inhibition in terms of poor pronunciation (2.24), L2 speakers do not understand

L1's speaking (2.31) and L1 speakers do not understand L2's speaking (2.26) and speaking speed (2.28).

Table 3

Level of Inhibiting Factors along with Linguistic Factors

Indicators	Mean	Level
1. English conversation is difficult because the grammar is weak, and the sentence structure cannot be formed.	2.79	High
2. English conversation is difficult because Korean and English have different word order.	2.67	High
3. English conversation is difficult because I don't know the vocabulary I'm trying to speak.	3.11	High
4. English conversation is difficult because I don't know the colloquial expression of English.	2.79	High
5. English conversation is difficult because I am not confident in English pronunciation, stress, and intonation.	2.24	Low
6. English conversation is difficult because I can't understand what native speakers said.	2.31	Low
7. English conversation is difficult when native speakers don't understand what I'm saying.	2.26	Low
8. English conversation is difficult because the speed of speech is so fast.	2.28	Low
Overall	**2.55**	**High**

Item statements 1 and 2 showed that Korean learners acquired a high level of inhibition concerning grammar and word order. It is difficult for them to construct sentences since their knowledge of grammar is weak, and the English and Korean languages have different word orders.

This corroborates the findings of Jung and Oh (2005), wherein the findings suggest that a lack of linguistic knowledge is a major barrier that learners encounter in their speaking skills. Accordingly, Smith (2018) stated that linguistic factors cover a wide range of issues that hinder the speaking proficiency of Korean learners, such as differences in phonological, grammatical, and lexical systems between the native language and the English language.

The high level of linguistic factors gained by Korean learners could be supported by Universal Grammar Theory. In the words of Chomsky (1965), he stated that humans are born with an innate set of grammatical principles that underlie all languages. For instance, Korean learners face challenges in English grammar due to the differences between Korean and English structures, that is, Subject-Object-Verb (Korean) vs. Subject-Verb-Object (English) order (Korean, 2025). As Korean and English have different word orders, they might transfer their L1 syntax to English, causing errors like “She apples eat” instead of “She ate apples”. Universal Grammar suggests that learners must reset parameters to match the target language.

Additionally, grammatical competence is emphasized by Hymes (1972), asserting its importance in constructing appropriate and meaningful utterances. Korean learners often possess strong grammatical competence due to the emphasis on grammar in language education, but are weak in real-life application. As explained by Canale and Swain (1990), grammatical competence includes the application of vocabulary, syntax, phonetics, and morphology in real-life situations.

Items statement 3 and 4 showed that Korean learners acquired a high level of inhibition in relation to vocabulary and colloquial expressions. It is difficult for them to speak since they do not know the right vocabulary and colloquial expressions to use.

This aligns with the study conducted by Kim and Margolis (2002), which stated that English classrooms in Korea focus on memory strategies in learning vocabulary rather than social strategies. These practices in the Korean classroom set-up limit Korean learners to practice speaking, which results in difficulties in using appropriate vocabulary in real-life contexts.

Comparatively, Simpson (2022) added that the Korean Educational System emphasizes memorization more than

critical thinking. Korean learners often rely on classroom instruction and structured materials, which limit their exposure to natural and meaningful input. Korean learners find it difficult to acquire and use high-frequency English vocabulary in real-life situations due to insufficient opportunities to interact with natural English. Instead, they focus on preparing for standardized tests such as TOEFL and TOEIC.

For good measure, according to the Input Hypothesis by Krashen (1985), vocabulary is acquired when learners are exposed to comprehensible input. However, Korean students often rely on decontextualized methods, such as word lists and direct translations, which impede deep processing and long-term retention of vocabulary.

Items statement 5, 6, 7, and 8 show that Korean learners acquired a low level of inhibition in terms of pronunciation, L2 speakers do not understand L1's speaking, L1 speakers do not understand L2's speaking, and speaking speed.

According to the study of Lee (2013), the most common errors produced by Korean learners are influenced by their native language pronunciation, as well as the lack of attention to pronunciation in English classes. Korean lacks

certain English sounds like /r/ and /l/, which may appear inconsistently in interlanguage (Korean, 2025). For instance, /low/ may sound /row/ and vice versa (Lee, 2013).

Similarly, according to Broselow and Park (1995), Korean intonation tends to be flatter than English, leading to monotonous speech that sounds unnatural or unclear. This means that Korean lacks stress-accented syllables, so learners often pronounce multisyllabic English words with equal emphasis, for instance, /kəmˈpyo͞odər/ may sound /kəmpyoodər/.

Furthermore, based on Interlanguage Theory by Selinker (1972), learners construct a certain linguistic system as they acquire a second language. Interlanguage is dynamic, explaining that it changes as learners gain more exposure to the target language and refine their understanding; however, it may also fossilize. This means that certain incorrect forms or patterns persist even after further instruction, resulting in certain errors. Similarly, poor pronunciation is influenced by interlanguage as the Korean and English language systems differ in phonological structures.

Additionally, by investigating how learners perceive and interpret linguistic input, researchers have identified

factors that impact speech production. For example, studies have shown that the ability to rapidly recognize and interpret individual sounds (phonetics) and word boundaries (phonology) contributes to improved listening skills and overall language understanding (Gass & Selinker, 2020). Accordingly, comprehending happens in communication, such as taking part in an interaction where the speakers and listeners take turns. As they take turns simultaneously, they undergo the process of comprehension, which includes prediction. Thus, prediction plays an important role in speech production, comprehension, and dialogue (Pickering & Garrod, 2013).

As a final point, based on Interactionist Theory by Long (1996), he emphasized the importance of focus on interaction and negotiation of meaning in language comprehension. He argues that language acquisition is facilitated through meaningful and authentic interactions that allow learners to negotiate meaning and engage in communication. Interactive activities provide opportunities for learners to practice and develop their speaking skills, leading to improved language proficiency. On the other hand, Negotiation of meaning occurs when learners and interlocutors engage in clarifying and modifying their

speech to achieve mutual understanding. This interactive process facilitates language acquisition as learners receive feedback, adjust their language output, and refine their communicative competence.

In conclusion, linguistic factors are the main barriers impeding the oral proficiency of Korean learners. It implies that inhibiting linguistic factors are significant in the speaking skills of Korean learners. Addressing these linguistic barriers could improve the oral proficiency of Korean learners.

Table 4 shows the level of inhibiting factors along with schematic factors.

Table 4

Level of Inhibiting Factors along with Schematic Factors

Indicators	Mean	Level
9. I feel the limit because I can't think of various topics when I speak English.	2.47	Low
10. The background knowledge of one particular topic is weak, so I can't talk long.	2.34	Low
11. English conversation is difficult due to lack of knowledge of English-speaking culture.	1.98	Low
12. I have a weak knowledge of the difference between Korean and English culture. I feel limited in English conversation.	2.02	Low
Overall	**2.20**	**Low**

Schematic Factors

As shown in Table 4, Korean learners perceived schematic factors as a low-level inhibiting factor with an overall mean of 2.20. Korean learners reported a low level of inhibition regarding the lack of various topics (2.47), lack of knowledge about a topic (2.34), lack of L2 culture (1.98), and cultural differences between L1 and L2 (2.02).

Items statement 9, 10, 11, and 12 show that Korean learners acquired a low level of inhibition concerning schematic factors. In the case of Korean learners, they do not feel a limit to their speaking skills as they can think of various topics when they speak in English. Speaking in English is not difficult for Korean learners due to a lack of knowledge of the differences between Korean and English cultures.

This is in contrast with the study of Jung and Oh (2005), which stated that the schematic domain is detrimental to the speaking skills of Korean learners. As supported by the study of Cocjin et al. (2019), the exposure of Korean learners to an English-speaking culture led them to improve their speaking skills as the learners were able to use the English language in everyday life and

scenarios. This implies that exposure to the real world helps in the improvement of speaking skills.

Accordingly, schemas allow learners to predict and process language efficiently, which is especially important in real-life communication. Lack of exposure and practice hinders the development of speaking skills of Korean learners, as English is often taught in classroom-based education (Kang,2018).

The above-mentioned schematic factors could be supported by Hymes (1972), who suggests that a learner must understand when, where, and how to use a language appropriately in a cultural context to be able to create meaningful conversations. Equally, this is in line with communicative competence theory of Canale and Swain (1980), which emphasizes the importance of sociolinguistic competence in speaking proficiency of learners as it involves understanding of appropriate language use in different social and cultural contexts.

In conclusion, schematic factors are not the main barriers to improving the oral proficiency of Korean learners. This means that schematic factors do not significantly hinder the oral proficiency of Korean learners. This suggests that Korean learners possess

sufficient knowledge of topics; however, it is not enough to improve their oral English proficiency skills.

Table 5 shows the level of inhibiting factors along with cognitive factors.

Table 5

Level of Inhibiting Factors along with Cognitive Factors

Indicators	Mean	Level
13. It is difficult to express in English after thinking in Korean.	2.64	High
14. English conversation is difficult due to the difference in thinking between Koreans and native speakers.	1.79	Low
15. I have a lot of knowledge in my head, but it is difficult to use in different situations to construct and convey new expressions.	2.97	High
16. Thinking a lot with excessive self-consciousness. I have difficulty expressing what I want to say outside.	2.21	Low
17. Because I have a more abstract way of thinking as an adult than as a child. It is an obstacle to English conversation.	2.28	Low
Overall	**2.38**	**Low**

Cognitive Factors

As shown in Table 5, Korean learners perceived cognitive factors as a low-level inhibiting factor with an overall mean of 2.38. Korean learners showed a high level of inhibition concerning thinking in L1 and speaking in English (2.64) and difficulty in using existing knowledge

(2.97), while indicating a low level of inhibition concerning cognitive difference between L1 and L2 (1.79), thinking too much, and adults' abstract thinking process (2.28).

Items 13 and 15 showed that Korean learners acquired a high level of inhibition in relation to thinking in their first language and speaking in their second language. It is difficult for them to express in English after thinking in their first language. They have a lot of knowledge in their heads, but they are having difficulties constructing and conveying new expressions.

The above-mentioned cognitive factors could be supported by Skill Acquisition Theory by DeKeyser (2007) explains how individuals acquire and develop new skills, which include both cognitive and psychomotor skills. As such, Korean learners could strengthen their cognitive abilities through structured practice, attention, and repetition, and eventually transition from thinking about English to using it fluently. Accordingly, Korean learners often start with grammar-heavy instructions and memorization, which impede them from using the rules in communicative usage and context. Skill Acquisition Theory

emphasizes the need for practice and meaningful use to reach fluency.

Comparatively, the Audio-Lingual Approach (1957) emphasizes the need for habit formation and automaticity with the help of pattern practice, repetition, and mimicry (Skinner, 1957). As such, Korean learners are overthinking instead of responding naturally. As mentioned by Skinner (1957), when learners are trained through drills and repetition, they develop automatic speech responses that could reduce the need for translation from their first language to the target language.

Moreover, in the psycholinguistic approach, cognitive processes include mental activities such as speech production, mental lexicon, and error monitoring, which collectively enable learners to acquire linguistic structures and develop communication skills (Hymes, 1972). Speech production involves conceptualization, formulation, and articulation, which Korean learners often struggle with due to the difference in syntax, phonology, and lexicon retrieval. This has the same findings about inhibiting linguistic factors of the current study.

Korean learners are required to mentally restructure their sentences in real time, which increases their

cognitive load. Additionally, Korean learners need to retrieve the proper vocabulary to use in speaking, which slows down their speaking and disrupts fluency. More importantly, articulation is a challenge as there are English sounds that are not present in the Korean language. These challenges often result in pauses and fillers, making it difficult to express in English after thinking in Korean and conveying new expressions.

Item statements 14, 16, and 17 showed that Korean learners acquired a low level of agreement concerning the cognitive difference between L1 and L2, thinking too much, and the adults' abstract thinking process.

Korean learners think a lot with excessive self-consciousness, leading to difficulty in expressing what they want to say. This could be explained by error monitoring in psycholinguistics (Kennison et al., 2014). In this stage, Korean learners check for errors in their speech before or after articulation, which could lead to over-monitoring their speech.

While the overall data suggest that cognitive factors are not major inhibitors, the high level of difficulty using stored knowledge and translating thoughts from Korean to English reveals specific cognitive barriers. With an

overall low mean score of 2.38, these factors are perceived to have minimal impact on students' ability to speak English. This suggests that learners generally possess the mental capacity to understand, retain, and organize language information effectively.

Table 6 shows the level of inhibiting factors along with affective factors.

Table 6

Level of Inhibiting Factors along with Affective Factors

Indicators	Mean	Level
18. English conversation is difficult because of my timid personality.	1.72	Very Low
19. There is a limit to English conversation due to lack of bold attempts.	2.12	Low
20. Anxiety such as frustration, self-doubt, etc. hinder English conversation.	1.82	Low
21. My pride is so strong that it interferes with my English conversation.	1.48	Very Low
22. There is no progress in English conversation due to lack of motivation.	1.67	Very Low
Overall	**1.76**	**Low**

Affective Factors

As shown in Table 6, Korean learners perceived affective factors as a low-level inhibiting factor with an overall mean of 1.76. Korean learners showed a low level of inhibition with respect to lack of risk-taking (2.12) and

anxiety, while indicating a very low level of inhibition with respect to introversion, self-esteem, and lack of motivation.

Items statement 19 and 20 showed that Korean learners acquired a low level of inhibition with respect to a lack of risk-taking and anxiety. Korean learners do not feel a limit to English conversation due to a lack of bold attempts, and anxiety, such as frustration and self-doubt, do not particularly hinder their conversation.

The above-mentioned affective factors have a conflicting result to the study of Kim (2018) and Yoon (2015) on the English speaking anxiety among Korean university students, where affective domains inhibit the oral proficiency of Korean learners. Additionally, Park and Lee (2014) found a link between language anxiety and English proficiency among Korean learners, which states that lower English proficiency leads to higher language anxiety. Furthermore, Chang (2014) found that Korean learners who engage in face-saving behavior tend to have lower speaking proficiency.

Accordingly, Hoque (2017) states that affective factors such as anxiety, empathy, and motivation are crucial in learning a new language. These affective factors

play a fundamental role in learners' engagement, language learning processes, and ultimately, their language learning outcomes. In the context of Korean English learners, understanding the affective domain is important because they often experience high levels of anxiety and self-consciousness when speaking English (Kim, 2016). These affective factors can significantly hinder their speaking proficiency.

The above findings could be explained by the Interactionist Theory by Long (1996), which emphasizes that language is best learned through meaningful interaction with others. Through a collaborative context, learners practice in socially supported environments where mistakes are normal and corrected gently. In an interactionist classroom, learners engage in dialogue and meaningful interactions, which reduces anxiety and pressure among learners. Learners are encouraged to reformulate their output, which boosts strategic competence and motivation and lowers fear of failure.

Furthermore, as supported by Communicative Competence Theory by Canale and Swain (1980), which focuses on strategic competence, it states that language learners should possess the ability to overcome communication

difficulties such as anxiety, fear of making mistakes, and lack of confidence when speaking the language to achieve the desired communication goals.

Moreover, Skill Acquisition Theory by DeKeyser (2007) states that anxiety and self-consciousness interfere with the autonomous stage, which impedes speech production, limiting opportunities for attaining meaningful feedback. The theory emphasizes structured and repeated practice, which helps learners become familiar and comfortable with speaking patterns. As learners progress to repeated practice and attain fluency, they may boost their motivation and lower stress and anxiety, making it relevant in improving the oral speaking proficiency of Korean learners.

In conclusion, affective factors, such as anxiety, lack of motivation, and fear of making mistakes, are not significant barriers to the oral English proficiency of Korean learners. This suggests that while emotional and psychological aspects may play a role in language learning, Korean learners do not perceive them as major obstacles.

Table 7 shows the level of inhibiting factors along with interactional factors.

Table 7

Level of Inhibiting Factors along with Interactional Factors

Indicators	Mean	Level
23. There is a limit to English conversation due to lack of opportunities to talk to native speakers.	2.21	Low
24. When I meet a native speaker personally, I can speak well, but I can't speak well in class.	1.60	Very Low
25. I can speak English well with Korean teachers, but I can't speak English well with a native speaker.	1.69 0000 0	Very Low
26. If there is a person who speaks well in one classroom, it shrinks and makes conversation difficult.	2.09	Low
27. I can't communicate well because I think my teacher evaluates my conversation skills.	1.69	Very Low
28. I can't communicate well because I think my friends are watching my conversation skills.	1.91	Low
29. It's hard to start talking because I'm not confident that I'll make an error.	2.00	Low
30. When I speak, the native speaker fixes it so often that it interferes with my conversation.	1.33	Very Low
31. Lack of time and economic leeway is an obstacle to conversation.	1.64	Very Low
32. The university entrance examination system and the exam-oriented school system are obstacles to conversation.	2.57	High
33. I feel the limit because I can't speak English at a younger time.	2.83	High
Overall	**1.96**	**Low**

Interactional Factors

As shown in Table 7, Korean learners perceived interactional factors as a low-level inhibiting factor in

general, with a total mean score of 1.96. Korean learners showed a low level of inhibition concerning few chances to speak with L2 speakers (2.21), being overwhelmed by proficient learners (2.09), peer's evaluation (1.91), and making mistakes (2.0), while indicating a very low level of inhibition concerning speaking in class vs. outside of class (1.6), speaking with L1 vs. L2 speakers (1.69), teacher's evaluation (1.69), and frequent error corrections (1.33).

Items statement 32 and 33 showed that Korean learners acquired a high level of inhibition concerning problems in the educational system (2.57), and a lack of early English education (2.83). Korean learners feel the limit of their speaking skills due to the educational system, and because they were unable to speak English at a younger age, leading to a lack of exposure to the language at an early age.

The above findings could potentially be explained by the Critical Period Hypothesis by Lenneberg (1967), suggesting that the younger a person is, the better they are at learning a second language. It explains that during childhood, the brain is especially receptive to language learning, leading to better language acquisition. After

this critical time frame, acquiring a language becomes increasingly challenging.

Subsequently, the Korean university entrance examination system and the exam-oriented school system added to this difficulty. According to education experts, people's "test score-oriented approach" to English study could be blamed for the sluggish proficiency improvement, and Koreans study English to win higher scores in tests at school or elsewhere rather than to have better communication in English. Moreover, communicative speaking ability is not tested, which is the major reason why Koreans' proficiency makes little progress despite extravagant spending on English learning.

Item statement 23 – 31 showed that Korean learners acquired a low and a very low level of inhibition concerning interactional factors. Korean learners encounter some limitations to English conversations due to a lack of opportunities to talk to native speakers, being overwhelmed by proficient learners in the classroom, friends' evaluation, and their fear of making mistakes. Additionally, Korean learners can speak better when they meet native speakers than in the classroom. Korean learners can speak better with Korean teachers than with native

teachers. Korean learners fear their teachers' evaluation, and Koreans feel the limit in conversation when native speakers correct their errors. Moreover, Korean learners fear peer evaluation and intimidation when their friends are watching them speaking in English, and when someone speaks English better in class, leading to low confidence in starting to speak in English.

The above findings can be explained by the Communicative Competence Theory by Canale and Swain (1980), emphasizing strategic competence. Strategic competence refers to the ability to use communication strategies to overcome difficulties and achieve communication goals. Korean learners may encounter inhibiting factors such as anxiety, fear of making mistakes, and lack of confidence when speaking English. These psychological barriers hinder their willingness to engage in communicative situations, limiting their strategic competence. These challenges hinder their chance to talk to native speakers.

Moreover, Social Interactionist Theory (Vygotsky, 1978) states that learning a new language is a social process that happens when learners interact with others in a meaningful way. Subsequently, the concept of the Zone of Proximal Development (ZPD) explains how learners progress

through guided support from more knowledgeable teachers or peers. That is when learners feel emotionally supported in these interactions; their emotional barriers in language learning are lowered, allowing them to participate more actively and confidently in speaking tasks.

In conclusion, interactional factors do not significantly hinder the oral English proficiency level of Korean learners. With a low mean score of 1.96, learners do not perceive these factors as major obstacles to their ability to speak English. This suggests that Korean students are generally capable of engaging in social aspects of communication when given the opportunity. The primary difficulties lie instead in linguistic competence, such as limited vocabulary and grammatical accuracy.

Summary of Findings

Table 8 shows the summary of the inhibiting factors.

Table 8

Summary of the Inhibiting Factors

Inhibiting Factors	Mean	Level
Linguistic Factors	2.55	High
Schematic Factors	2.20	Low
Cognitive Factors	2.38	Low
Affective Factors	1.76	Low
Interactional Factors	1.96	Low

Table 8 shows the total mean scores and the level of inhibiting factors. It shows that Korean learners garnered a mean score of 2.55 (high level), schematic with a mean score of 2.20 (low level), cognitive with a mean score of 2.38 (low level), affective with a mean score of 1.76 (low level), and interactional with a mean score of 1.96 (low level). The findings imply that the linguistic factors are the main factors that affect their speaking proficiency.

The data presented in Table 9 indicate that among the five identified factors affecting the oral English proficiency of Korean learners, linguistic factors received the highest mean score of 2.55, which corresponds to a high level of influence. In contrast, schematic (M = 2.20), cognitive (M = 2.38), affective (M = 1.76), and interactional (M = 1.96) factors all fall within the low level range.

This suggests that linguistic limitations, such as insufficient vocabulary, grammatical inaccuracies, and pronunciation challenges, are perceived by learners as the most significant barriers to their ability to speak English fluently. These findings support the idea that, despite being exposed to English instruction over many years, Korean learners still struggle with the core structural

components of the language needed for spontaneous verbal communication.

Moreover, the low mean scores for schematic and cognitive factors indicate that Korean learners generally possess the necessary background knowledge and mental processing skills to support language learning. Their challenges are not due to a lack of content familiarity or intellectual capability, but rather to difficulties in language form and expression.

Furthermore, the affective and interactional factors, both with the lowest mean scores, imply that while classroom anxiety, motivation, and lack of communication opportunities do affect speaking ability, learners do not perceive these as the primary obstacles. However, the relatively low scores in these areas still warrant attention, as they may indirectly influence learners' willingness to engage in speaking tasks and apply their linguistic knowledge.

Taken together, the findings indicate that while Korean learners have the cognitive ability and topic familiarity to engage in conversation, their linguistic limitations, as supported by multiple SLA theories, are the primary reason for low oral English proficiency. These

results underscore the need for pedagogical approaches that go beyond comprehension and focus more on productive language skills, especially through structured vocabulary building, targeted grammar instruction, and pronunciation practice, all supported within low-anxiety, interaction-rich environments.

The Relationship Between English Speaking Proficiency and the Inhibiting Factors in Improving the Proficiency of Korean Learners

The third question focused the relationship between English speaking skill proficiency and the inhibiting factors in improving the proficiency of Korean learners. The variables, correlation coefficient, significance, findings, interpretation and decision are shown in Table 9.

As shown in Table 9, there is a significant, moderate relationship between the oral proficiency and the linguistic factors with a correlation coefficient of .461 and a Person correlation of -.41. This indicates that linguistic factors are associated in the improvement of the oral proficiency of Korean learners, meaning as the English proficiency level of the learners' increases, the inhibiting linguistic factors decreases and vice versa. In the same way, as learners improve their oral proficiency,

they experience fewer challenges related to vocabulary, colloquial expression, grammar, and word order.

Table 9

Correlation

Variables	Correlation Coefficient	Sig.	Findings	Interpre-tation	Person Corre-lation
1. Oral English Proficiency Level Linguistic Factors	.461	.002	Significant	Moderate Relationship	-.41
2. Oral English Proficiency Level Schematic Factors	.234	.809	Not Significant	-	.03
3. Oral English Proficiency Level Cognitive Factors	.405	.015	Significant	Moderate Relationship	-.32
4. Oral English Proficiency Level Affective Factors	.334	.037	Significant	Weak Relationship	-.28
5. Oral English Proficiency Level Interactional Factors	.420	.071	Not Significant	-	-.24

The significant relationship between oral proficiency and the inhibiting linguistic factors could be supported by the Universal Grammar theory. As stated by Chomsky (1986), all humans have an innate capacity for language learning,

which explains that as learners become more proficient, their grammatical skills also improve, thus reducing linguistic barriers. However, if learners lack exposure to the target language, this innate ability may not be fully activated. This could be further explained by the Input Hypothesis (Krashen, 1985), which states that learners need to be exposed to English that is just beyond their current level to be able to advance linguistically.

Moreover, when Korean learners lack grammatical competence, they cannot respond and express themselves fluently, as speaking requires real-time access to language forms, which aligns with the Communicative Competence Theory (Canale & Swain, 1980). As such, learners who are linguistically limited are less likely to communicate fluently or accurately. Additionally, Selinker (1972) explains that learners construct their own evolving language systems, which could fossilize, resulting in errors. With continuous input and feedback, these systems could improve or be closer to the target language, leading to fewer linguistic errors.

As shown in Table 9, there is a significant, moderate relationship between the oral proficiency and the cognitive factors with a correlation coefficient of .405 and a Person

correlation of -.32. This indicates that cognitive factors are associated in the improvement of the oral proficiency of Korean learners, meaning as the English proficiency level of the learners' increases, the inhibiting cognitive factors decreases and vice versa. In the same way, as learners improve their oral proficiency, they experience fewer challenges related to vocabulary, colloquial expression, grammar, and word order.
This means that, as proficiency rises, their cognitive strain reduces.

The significant relationship between oral proficiency and the inhibiting cognitive factors could be supported by DeKeyser (2007), stating that frequent speaking practice may result in cognitive fluency, which reduces mental effort in retrieving vocabulary and structuring speech. Additionally, Psycholinguistic Approaches state that by focusing on application and communication, learners tend to understand the language easily. Additionally, Interlanguage Theory (Selinker, 1972) also explains that Korean learners are still building their own language system, making their speech unstable. Understanding cognitive barriers could help Korean learners express what they want to say smoothly.

As shown in Table 9, there is a significant, weak relationship between the oral proficiency and the affective factors with a correlation coefficient of .334 and a Person correlation of -.28. This indicates that affective factors are associated in the improvement of the oral proficiency of Korean learners, meaning as the English proficiency level of the learners' increases, the inhibiting affective factors decreases and vice versa. This means that as proficiency rises, learners' emotional and psychological barriers decrease.

The significant relationship between oral proficiency and the inhibiting cognitive factors could be supported by Interactionist Theory, which states that emotional conditions like anxiety can block language acquisition (Long, 1996). The theory emphasizes the importance of social interaction and engaging in real-life situations to eventually combat emotional distress. When learners are engaged in interaction, they can give more input and output. As supported by strategic competence, coping strategies for managing breakdowns in communication help learners feel more confident and less anxious when speaking. Furthermore, the Social Interactionist Theory emphasizes the role of social and guided interaction in

learning a language and proposes that learners can only learn a new language through social interaction with adults and other children (Vygotsky, 1978).

Overall, as English proficiency level increases, inhibiting linguistic, cognitive, and affective factors decreases, and vice versa. In contrast, no significant relationship was seen between schematic and interactional factors and English proficiency level. As suggested by Communicative Competence Theory, learning a language requires explicit instruction and exposure to authentic conversation interaction. The lack of significant correlation may reflect a gap in learners' opportunities to practice real-time interaction, even when their grammar and vocabulary improve.

Chapter 4

Conclusions and Recommendations

This chapter presents the conclusions and recommendations based on the study.

Conclusions

Based on the findings of the study, the researcher arrived at the following conclusions:

1. Korean learners hold mostly an English proficiency level of A2 and B1.

2. All of the inhibiting factors contributes to the low English Proficiency of Korean learners.

3. Among the inhibiting factors, linguistics has the highest significant relationship as Korean learners struggle mostly on vocabulary, grammar, word order, and colloquial expressions.

Recommendations

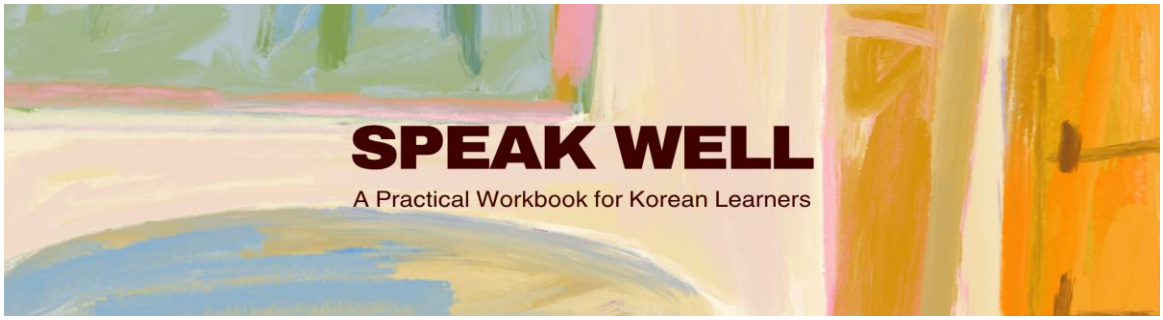
Based on the findings, the following are recommended:

1. Educators may want to address challenges faced by Korean learners especially the linguistic factors.

2. Educators may provide focused lessons on grammar, vocabulary, pronunciation and fluency, and contextualize the learning materials focusing on speaking. Future researchers may want to focus more on linguistic factors,

extend the population with other nationalities to find any other relationships related to the field of second language learning, and elicit other inhibiting factors.

3. A bigger population is recommended as the study was limited to a few academies in Baguio English School Association.



환영합니다! Welcome to 'Speak Well,' a workbook designed to help Korean learners master English grammar, expand their vocabulary, and confidently use English in everyday situations. Let's embark on this exciting journey together!

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Next Steps

Start with the first section and work through each chapter sequentially. Take your time, practice regularly, and don't hesitate to review previous lessons. Consistent effort is key to achieving your language learning goals. 화이팅! (Fighting!)

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Part 1: Practical English Grammar Workbook for Korean L2 Learners

This workbook is designed to help Korean learners of English progress through different levels of proficiency from A1 to C1 as defined by the Common European Framework of Reference for Languages (CEFR). It integrates key grammar concepts, vocabulary, and practical activities based on Communicative Language Teaching (CLT), Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT), and Total Physical Response (TPR) approaches. This workbook is intended for one on one and group classes. This workbook is designed to be interactive, engaging, and aligned with the CEFR framework. It ensures learners develop both accuracy and fluency in English grammar while incorporating modern teaching methodologies.

Overview of CEFR Levels:

A1 (Beginner): Basic vocabulary, simple sentences, and everyday expressions.
A2 (Elementary): Can communicate in simple tasks and describe familiar topics.
B1 (Intermediate): Can handle most situations while traveling and express opinions.
B2 (Upper-Intermediate): Can interact fluently and produce detailed text on various topics.
C1 (Advanced): Can use language flexibly and effectively for professional or academic purposes.

To use this workbook effectively:

Start with your A1 level and progress gradually. Use the communicative tasks to practice speaking and listening with a teacher. Complete task-based exercises to apply grammar, vocabulary and syntax in real-life scenarios. Incorporate TPR activities for kinesthetic learning.

Incorporating Communicative, Task-Based, and TPR Approaches.

Communicative Language Approach: Focus on real-life communication through role-plays, discussions, and pair work.

Task-Based Language Approach: Use tasks like writing emails, making plans, or solving problems to practice grammar in context

Total Physical Response (TPR): Use actions and gestures to reinforce vocabulary and grammar (e.g., acting out verbs)

A1 LEVEL
UNIT 1: PARTS OF SPEECH

Chapter 1: Nouns

Definition: Noun is a word that names something such as a person, place, thing, or idea.

Examples:

Name of people: teacher, student, doctor, Kim,	Name of places: school, park, Korea, America,	Name of things: book, pencil, paper, table, apple	Name of ideas: love, happiness, freedom

Exercises:

A. Read aloud the following sentences and tell me which words are nouns:

1. The cat is sleeping on the bed.
2. She buys a new phone.
3. The students are studying.
4. Sandara lives in South Korea.
5. Mina eats apple every day.

B. Task-Based Activity: "Find the Nouns" Scavenger Hunt
Look around you and name the things you see.

C. Name the things that are used for school.

D. Name the things in your room.

E. Name the things in the kitchen.

F. Name the things you always carry.

G. Name important people in your life.

H. Name your favorite animals.

I. Name your favorite food.

J. Communicative Activity: "Introduce Your Friend"

Direction: Tell me about your best friend using as many nouns as possible.



A1 Level

Unit 1: Parts of Speech

Chapter 2: Pronouns

Definition: Pronoun is a word that replaces a noun to avoid repetition.

Examples:

Subject Pronouns	Object Pronouns
I, You, He, She, It, We, They	Me, You, Him, Her, It, Us,



Exercises:

Read aloud the sentences and replace the underlined words with pronouns:

1. Maria is my best friend.
2. I see a dog in the park.
3. Ms. Kim is our teacher.
4. Mr. Park is the owner.
5. The children are playing.

A. Say the correct subject pronoun for each sentence:

1. (He/They) is reading a book.
2. (I/She) am going to the store.
3. (It/We) is raining today.
4. (We/It) are going to school.
5. (I/They) are eating.

B. Say the correct object pronoun:

1. John is talking to ____ (us/we).
2. I am going to meet _____ (he/him).
3. The teacher gives _____ (she/her) the paper.
4. Can you call _____ (me/I) later?
5. Do you like _____ (him/he)?

C. Communicative Activity: "Who Am I?" Game
Direction: Student describes someone/something using pronouns:
Example: "He is wearing a blue shirt." Others guess who it is.



A1 Level

Unit 1: Parts of Speech

Chapter 3: Verbs

Definition: A verb is a word that shows an action.

Examples:

Action Verbs:

run, eat, play,
study, sleep, learn,
work, make, do,
cook, drink

Go and goes, play and plays

- I, You, We, They -> go, play
  I go to school. You go to school.
  You go to school. We go to school.
- He, She, The boy, The girl -> add -s/-es
  He goes to school. She plays at the park.
  The boy plays a ball. The girl plays a doll.



Exercises:

A. Tell me the verbs in the sentences below:

1. She runs every morning.
2. He eats ramyeon at night.
3. The children study every day.
4. I go to work at 7:30 am.
5. I watch Kdrama every weekend.
6. Nahyun likes coffee.
7. My mom cooks for us.
8. The teacher teaches a new lesson.
9. The dog eats bones.
10. The cat jumps over the dog.

B. Communicative Activity: "Daily Routine Sharing"
Direction: In small groups, share your daily routine using at least five action verbs.

C. Total Physical Response Activity: "Simon Says" with Verbs

Direction: Play "Simon Says" using action verbs (e.g., "Simon says run," "Simon says jump").

A1 Level

Unit 1: Parts of Speech

Chapter 4: Adjectives

Definition: An adjective is a word that describes a noun or pronoun.

Examples:

Colors: red, blue, green etc.

Sizes: big, small, tall, short

Qualities: pretty, smart, kind , happy, sad

Form: adjective + noun

Smart kid	red pen
Long table	blue ball
Handsome man	sad girl

Exercises:

A. Say the adjectives in the sentences below:

1. The tall man is my uncle.
2. She has a beautiful dress.
3. This is a delicious cake.
4. I want a big bag.
5. She wants a cozy house.

B. Communicative Activity: "Describe and Guess" Game

Direction: Describe an object without naming it: "It is round and red." Others guess the object.

C. Total Physical Response Activity: "Act the Adjective"

Direction: The teacher says an adjective (like "happy" or "sad"), and students act it out.

D. Match the nouns with the proper adjectives. Cross out the pictures as you say the answers to your teacher.

A1 Level

Unit 1: Parts of Speech

Chapter 5: Adverbs

Definition: An adverb is a word that modifies a verb, an adjective, or another adverb.

Examples:

Manner: quickly, slowly, well

Time: now, yesterday, soon

Degree: very, quite, too

Form: verb + adverb
(eat quickly)
Adverb + adjective

(very pretty)

Exercises:

A. Identify and say the adverbs in the following sentences:

1. He speaks slowly.
2. She is very happy.
3. They will arrive soon.
4. I will go tomorrow.
5. The teacher explains well.

B. Speak and complete the sentences and add an adverb to each:

1. She sings _____
2. Jennie dances _____.
3. He runs _____
4. The movie is _____ interesting.
5. The park is _____ far.

C. Communicative Activity: "How Did You Do It?" Sharing
Direction: Share how you completed a recent task using adverbs of manner (e.g., "I did it quickly.").



D. Total Physical Response Activity: "Move as Directed"
Direction: The teacher gives instructions using adverbs: "Walk slowly," "Jump quickly."



A2 Level

Unit 2: Basic Sentence Structure

Chapter 1: Subject – Verb – Object (SVO)

Explanation: A subject verb object (SVO) sentence has a subject, a verb, and an object. The subject is the person or thing performing the action, the verb is the action, and the object is the person or thing receiving the action

Examples:

S	V	O
I	watch	a movie.
I	bake	a cake.
I	cook	rice.

Examples:

- She speaks English.
- Does she speak English?
- She doesn't speak English.
- You speak English.
- Do you speak English?
- You do not speak English.



Exercises:

A. Identify and speak the subject, verb, or object in each sentences:

1. I drink water. Subject: _____
2. Kim buys a new book. Object: _____
3. She likes pizza. Verb: _____
4. Mina goes to work every day. Verb: _____
5. I met my friends yesterday. Subject: _____

B. Communicative Activity: "Daily Routine Sharing"

Direction: Share your daily routine, what do you do in a day? Use SVO in constructing your sentences.

C. Communicative Activity: "What did you do yesterday?"

Direction: Share what you did yesterday using simple past and SVO in constructing your sentences.



A2 Level

Unit 2: Basic Sentence Structure

Chapter 2: Present Simple Tense

Explanation: Present Simple Tense is used to indicate the current action or an action that takes place regularly.

FORM: [VERB] + s/es
Cook + s = cooks
Do + es = does



Exercises:

A. Make the following sentences correct by speaking.

1. I plays tennis in the afternoon.
2. She do not play tennis.
3. Do he play tennis?
4. The train leave every morning at 8 AM.
5. The train do not leave at 9 AM.
6. When do the train usually leave?
7. She always forget her purse.
8. He never forget his wallet.
9. Every week, I goes shopping.
10. Do she go shopping?

B. Communicative Activity: "Daily Routines"
Direction: Write down your daily routine, use at least 5 verbs. Discuss your daily routine to your class or teacher.

C. Communicative Activity: "Weekly Routines"
Direction: Write down your weekly routine, use at least 10 verbs. Discuss your daily routine to your class or teacher.



A2 Level

Unit 2: Basic Sentence Structure

Chapter 3: Past Simple Tense

Explanation: A Past Simple Tense is a verb form of a sentence that tells about any action, event, moment, or circumstance that happened in the past or occurred completely.

FORM: [VERB+ed/d] or irregular verbs
bake + d = baked
play + ed = played
do = did
eat = ate

Examples:

- You called Jian.
- Did you call Jian?
- You did not call Jian.
- I ate kimchi.
- Did I eat kimchi?
- I did not eat Kimchi.



Exercises:

A. Change the present verbs into past verbs to make the sentences correct by speaking.

1. I _____ (see) the movie yesterday.
2. She _____ (buy) a watch for her father.
3. What did you _____ (cook) for dinner?
4. Last year, I _____ (travel) to the Philippines.
5. He _____ (wash) his car last week.
6. My sister _____ (finish) work, _____ (prepare) for her trip, and _____ (clean) her room.
7. Dad _____ (arrive) at the airport 20 minutes ago.
8. He _____ (check) into the hotel.

B. Communicative Activity: "My trip"
Direction: Recall your recent trip and use at least 5 regular verbs and 5 irregular verbs. Discuss your trip to your teacher.



A2 Level

Unit 2: Basic Sentence Structure

Chapter 4: Future Tense

Explanation: Future Tense is a verb form of a sentence that tells an action that will happen in the future.

FORM: BE[am/is/are + going to + VERB]
am + going + to bake

FORM: will + verb
Will bake

Examples:

- You will help Juha later.
- Will you help Juha later?
- You will not help Juha later.
- I am going to play tennis at night.
- Will I play tennis at night?
- I am not going to play tennis at night.



Exercises:

A. Change the form "will + verb" into "going to" by speaking.

1. You will meet Jane tonight.

   _____

2. Will you meet Jane tonight?

   _____

3. You will not meet Jane tonight.

   _____

4. I will study hard.

   _____

5. I will be a doctor.

   _____

B. Communicative Activity: "Who will I become"?

Direction: Talk about what you think you will be in the future. Tell about your future job, hobbies, ideal family and your personality.

B1 Level

Unit 3: Prepositions

Chapter 1: Prepositions of Place

Explanation: Prepositions are words that express relationships of various sorts between a noun or pronoun and another word in a sentence.

Examples:

In: Used when something is inside a space.
- "The book is in the bag."

On: Used when something is on a surface.
- "The phone is on the table."

At: Used for a point or specific location.
- "She is at the door."

Exercises:

A. Task-Based Activity: "Room Mapping"

Direction: Draw a simple room layout and describe and discuss where objects are using prepositions. You must use in, on, and at.

B. Physical Response Activity: "Point and Touch"

Direction: The teacher says a preposition, and students point to or touch an object that matches the description.



B1 Level

Unit 3: Prepositions

Chapter 2: Prepositions of Time

Explanation: Prepositions are words that express relationships of various sorts between a noun or pronoun and another word in a sentence.

In: Used for months, years, centuries, and periods.
- "I was born in July."

On: Used for days and dates.
- "We have a meeting on Monday."

At: Used for specific times.
- "The train arrives at 5 PM."



Exercises:

A. Choose and say the correct preposition (in, on, at):

1. The concert is _____ Saturday.
2. I usually wake up _____ 7 a.m.
3. The drama starts _____ 10 p.m.
4. She will travel _____ 2025.
5. My birthday is _____ September.
6. The book was published _____ 2020.
7. I am going to meet him _____ Tuesday.
8. Flower blooms _____ spring.
9. People build snowman _____ winter.
10. They left _____ the morning.

B. Task-Based Activity: "Plan an Event"

Direction: Create an itinerary for an event, specifying dates and times using prepositions. Discuss the event to your teacher.

_____
_____
_____
_____
_____



B1 Level

Unit 3: Prepositions

Chapter 3: Prepositions of Movement

Explanation: Prepositions are words that express relationships of various sorts between a noun or pronoun and another word in a sentence.

To: Indicates movement toward a specific destination.
- "He is going to the park."

Into: Indicates entry into a space.
- "She walked into the room."

Onto: Indicates movement toward a surface.
- "He jumped onto the stage."

Through: Indicates movement within a space with boundaries.
- "We walked through the forest."



Exercises:

A. Say the correct prepositions (to, into, onto, through) in the following sentences:

1. He drove _____ the tunnel.
2. She climbed _____ the roof.
3. He passed _____ the window.
4. The boss went _____ his office.
5. The dog chased the cat _____ the house.

B. Communicative Activity: "How Do I Get There?"

Directions: Give and follow directions to navigate a simple map.

C. Task-Based Activity: "City Tour Plan"

Direction: Create a guided tour plan using prepositions of movement and discuss to your teacher.

_____
_____
_____
_____



B2 Level

Unit 4: The Progressive Tenses

Chapter 1: Present Continuous Tense

Explanation: The Present Continuous Tense describes an ongoing action that is happening in the present or continuing action.

FORM: [am/is/are + present participle(verb-ing)]
am/is/are + writing
am/is/are + sending
am/is/are + watching

Examples:

- I am studying English.
- Am I studying English?
- I am not studying English.
- She is meeting her friends.
- Is she meeting her friends?
- She is not meeting her friends.



Exercises:

A. Say the correct form of the verb using present continuous tense:

1. She _____ (read) a book right now.
2. They _____ (have) an argument at the moment.
3. We _____ (make) kimbap for picnic.
4. He _____ (mix) bibimbap.
5. I _____ (sing) in the bathroom.

B. Observe and tell me three sentences about what people around you are doing.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

C. Communicative Activity: "What are you doing right now?"

Direction: Pair up and ask each other what they are doing at the moment.

Example exchange:

A: "What are you doing right now?"

B: "I am writing in this workbook."



B2 Level

Unit 4: The Progressive Tenses

Chapter 2: Past Continuous Tense

Explanation: The Past Continuous Tense expresses a continuing past action when another action took place.

FORM: [was/were + present participle(verb-ing)]
was/were + discussing
was/were + visiting
was/were + deleting

Examples:

- I was studying when you called.
- Was I studying when you called?
- I was not studying when you called.
- You were cooking when I arrived.
- Were you cooking when I arrived?
- You were not cooking when I arrived.



Exercises:

A. Say the correct form of the verb using past continuous tense:

1. They _____ (play) when it started raining.
2. I _____ (read) when the phone rang.
3. She _____ (prepare) her luggage when someone knocked the door.
4. It _____ (missing) when I arrived.
5. We _____ (waiting) when they called.

B. Say three sentences describing what you were doing at different times yesterday.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

C. Task-Based Activity: "Interrupted Stories"

Direction: Tell a short story with at least three examples of the past progressive tense and an interruption using the simple past.
Example: "I was walking to school when it started raining."



B2 Level

Unit 4: The Progressive Tenses

Chapter 3: Future Continuous Tense

Explanation: The Future Continuous Tense expresses activities that will be in progress in the future.

FORM:[will be + present participle(verb-ing)]
will be + waiting

[am/is/are + going to be +present participle(verb-ing)]
am/is/are + going to be + waiting

Examples:

- You will be waiting for her when her plane arrives tonight.
- Will you be waiting for her when her plane arrives tonight?
- You will not be waiting for her when her plane arrives tonight.
- You are going to be waiting for her when her plane arrives tonight.
- Are you going to be waiting for her when her plane arrives tonight?
- You are not going to be waiting for her when her plane arrives tonight.



Exercises:

A. Say the correct form of the verbs using future continuous tense:

1. This time next year, I _____ (travel) around Europe.
2. She _____ (perform) at the concert tomorrow night.
3. I _____ (present) my proposal in two months.
4. They _____ (make) Kimjang in winter.

5. We _____ (sing) in the singing room on her birthday.

B. Communicative Activity: "Plans for the Future"
Direction: Discuss with your teacher what you will be doing at different times tomorrow or next weekend.
Example: "At 10 AM tomorrow, I will be studying for my test."

C. Task-Based Activity: "Event Timeline"
Direction: Create a timeline for a future event (like a vacation or party) and describe the activities using the future progressive tense.



C1 Level

Unit 5: The Perfect Tenses

Chapter 1: Present Perfect Tense

Explanation: The Present Perfect Tense expresses a condition that has existed in the past up to the present moment, and is still true at the present.

FORM: (Have/Has + Past Participle)
Have + been
Have + worked
Has + created
Has + made

Examples:

- You have seen that movie many times.
- Have you seen that movie many times?
- You have not seen that movie many times.
- I have been to France.
- Have I been to France?
- I have not been to France.



Exercises:

A. Say the correct form of the verbs using present perfect tense:
1. She _____(travel) to New York.
2. They _____ (complete) their project.
3. You _____ (grow) since the last time I saw you.

4. I _____ (become) more interested in English.
5. My English _____ (improve) since I moved to the Philippines.

B. Tell me five sentences about your recent activities using the Present Perfect tense.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

C. Communicative Activity: "Have You Ever?" Game:
Direction: Students ask each other questions about life experiences using "Have you ever...?"



C1 Level

Unit 5: The Perfect Tenses

Chapter 2: Present Perfect Continuous Tense

Explanation: The Present Perfect Continuous Tense describes an action that began in the past, continues in the present, and may continue in the future.

FORM: (has/have been + Past Participle)
Has been + waiting
Have been + working

Examples:

- You have been waiting here for two hours.
- Have you been waiting here for two hours?
- You have not been waiting here for two hours.
- They have been talking for the last hour.
- She has been working at that company for three years.
- What have you been doing for the last 30 minutes?

Exercises:

A. Complete and speak the sentences using present perfect continuous tense:

1. He _____ (study) for the exam.
2. They _____ (wait) for the doctor since morning.
3. James _____ (teach) at the university since June.
4. We _____ (wait) here for over two hours!
5. Recently, I _____ (feel) really tired.

B. Tell me three sentences about activities you have been doing recently.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

C. Task-Based Activity: "Daily Routine Report"

Direction: Tell me a report on activities you have been doing throughout the day.

C1 Level

Unit 5: The Perfect Tenses

Chapter 3: Past Perfect Tense

Explanation: The Past Perfect Continuous Tense is used to show that an action took place once or many times before another point in the past.

FORM: (had + Past Participle)
Had + waited
Had + worked

Examples:

- You had studied English before you moved to New York.
- Had you studied English before you moved to New York?
- You had not studied English before you moved to New York.
- I had never seen such a beautiful beach before I went to Kauai.
- I did not have any money because I had lost my wallet.
- Tony knew Istanbul so well because he had visited the city several times.



Exercises:

A. Complete the sentences with the correct form by speaking:

1. By the time the bus arrived, we _____ (wait) for an hour.
2. She _____ (finish) her homework before dinner.
3. I _____(leave) when he arrived.
4. They _____(finish) dinner before the movie started.
5. I did not have any money because I _____ (lose) my wallet.

B. Task-based Activity: "Timeline Creation Task"

Direction: Create and tell a timeline of events for a historical story, indicating which actions happened first using the Past Perfect.

C. Communicative Activity: "Story Swap"

Direction: Partners create a short story, inserting events in the Past Perfect tense.

Answer Key

A1 Level
Unit 1
Chapter 1:
1. cat, bed
2. phone
3. students
4. Sandara, South Korea
5. Mina

Chapter 2:

A:
1. She
2. it
3. she
4. he
5. they

B:
1. He
2. I
3. It
4. we
5. they

C:
1. Us
2. Him
3. her
4. me
5. him

Chapter 3:
1. runs
2. eats
3. study
4. go
5. watch
6. likes
7. cooks
8. teaches
9. eats
10. jumps

Chapter 4:
1. tall
2. beautiful
3. delicious
4. big
5. cozy

Chapter 5:
1. slowly
2. very
3. soon
4. tomorrow
5. well

A2 Level
Unit 2
Chapter 1:
1. I
2. a new book
3. likes
4. goes
5. I

Chapter 2
1. plays
2. does
3. does
4. leaves
5. does not
6. does
7. forgets
8. forgets
9. go
10. does

Chapter 3:
1. saw
2. brought
3. cooked
4. travelled
5. washed
6. finished, prepared, cleared

7. arrived
8. checked

Chapter 4:
1. You are going to meet Jane tonight
2. Are you going to meet Jane tonight?
3. You are not going to meet Jane tonight.
4. I'm going to study hard.
5. I am going to be a doctor.

B1 Level
Unit 3
Chapter 2
1. on
2. at
3. at
4. in
5. in
6. in
7. on
8. in
9. in
10. in

Chapter 3
1. through
2. onto
3. through
4. into
5. into

B2 Level
Unit 4

Chapter 1
1. reading
2. having
3. making
4. mixing
5. singing

Chapter 2
1. were playing
2. was reading
3. was preparing
4. was missing
5. were waiting

Chapter 3
1. will be travelling
2. is going to be performing
3. am going to be presenting
4. will be going to be making
5. are going to be singing

C1 Level
Unit 5
Chapter 1
1. has travelled
2. have completed
3. have grown
4. have become
5. has improved

Chapter 2
1. has been studying
2. have been waiting
3. has been teaching
4. have been waiting
5. have been traveling

Chapter 3
1. had waited
2. had finished
3. had left
4. had finished
5. had lost

Part 2: Practical English Speaking Workbook for Korean Learners

This workbook is designed to help Korean learners of English speak more naturally and confidently using common colloquial expressions, and phrasal verbs. Each unit is carefully aligned with CEFR levels from A1 to C1 and uses real-life communication contexts to build your fluency step by step.

You will find sentence patterns, mini-dialogues, and authentic expressions used in casual conversations by native speakers. This workbook follows communicative and task-based approaches, meaning that every unit includes practical speaking tasks and fluency challenges to encourage real-world interaction.

To use this workbook effectively:

1. Start at your level – Begin with the unit closest to your CEFR level or review earlier ones to build confidence.
2. Study the expressions – Read the key expressions, phrasal verbs, and sentence patterns.
3. Practice the dialogues – Say them aloud with a partner or record yourself.

4. Complete the tasks – Engage in role-plays, debates, or storytelling to apply what you've learned.

Challenge yourself – Push your fluency with time-limited tasks that simulate real-life pressure.

 **A1 – Unit 1: Saying Hello and Introducing Yourself**

Goal: Greet someone and introduce yourself casually.

Sentence Patterns:

- "I'm [Name]. I'm from [Place]."
- "This is my friend, [Name]."
- "I'm a [job/student]."
- "Nice to meet you."
- "Where are you from?"

Key Expressions:

- "What's up?"
- "How's it going?"
- "Nice to meet ya!"
- "Not much. You?"
- "Long time no see!"

Phrasal Verbs:

- "meet up" – to gather with someone socially
- "come from" – to be from a place
- "get along" – to have a good relationship
- "run into" – to meet unexpectedly
- "catch up" – to talk after a time apart

Colloquial Expressions:

- "Hey there!"
- "No worries."
- "All good."
- "It's chill."
- "Cool!"

Mini Dialogue:
A: Hey! What's up?
B: Not much. How's it going?
A: Good! I'm Mina. I'm from Seoul.
B: Nice to meet ya, Mina. I'm Jay.

Speaking Task: Role-play meeting at an international camp.
Fluency Challenge: Introduce yourself to three classmates/teacher in 60 seconds.



A2 – Unit 2: Making Plans
Goal: Make and accept casual plans with friends.

Sentence Patterns:
- "How about [verb+ing]?"
- "Let's [verb] this weekend."
- "Are you free [time]?"
- "Do you wanna [verb]?"
- "What do you feel like doing?"

Key Expressions:
- "Wanna hang out?"
- "Let's grab a bite."
- "Sounds good!"
- "I'm down."
- "Maybe later."

Phrasal Verbs:
- "hang out" – to spend time relaxing
- "come over" – to visit someone at their place
- "pick up" – to collect someone or something
- "drop by" – to visit briefly
- "head out" – to leave home or a place

Colloquial Expressions:
- "I'm in."
- "Count me out."
- "Let's bounce."
- "Chill night."
- "No biggie."

Mini Dialogue:
A: Wanna hang out this Friday?
B: Sure! How about watching a movie?
A: Sounds good. Let's grab a bite after.

Speaking Task: Create a weekly schedule with a partner.
Fluency Challenge: Make spontaneous plans using 3 key expressions in 2 minutes.

 **B1 – Unit 3: Sharing Opinions**
Goal: Express your opinion in a friendly discussion.

Sentence Patterns:
- "In my opinion, [that clause]."
- "I think [something] is [opinion]."
- "I agree/disagree because…"
- "What I mean is…"
- "It seems to me that…"

Key Expressions:
- "I'd say…"
- "To be honest…"
- "It depends."
- "Fair enough."
- "I'm not so sure."

Phrasal Verbs:
- "point out" – to mention something
- "bring up" – to start talking about something
- "think over" – to consider something carefully
- "speak out" – to express your opinion
- "go along with" – to agree with someone

Colloquial Expressions:
- "You've got a point."
- "I hear ya."
- "Sort of."
- "Not really my thing."
- "Totally."

Mini Dialogue:
A: What do you think about online classes?
B: To be honest, I prefer face-to-face.
A: I'd say online is more flexible.

Speaking Task: Debate: "City life is better than countryside life."
Fluency Challenge: Share your opinion in 1 minute without using "um" or "uh."



B2 – Unit 4: Telling Stories
Goal: Tell a short story using conversational English.

Sentence Patterns:

- "I was [verb+ing] when [event]."
- "Suddenly, [past tense event]."
- "And then…"
- "You won't believe what happened."
- "Next thing I knew…"

Key Expressions:

- "You won't believe what happened…"
- "So there I was…"
- "Long story short…"
- "Guess what?"
- "No kidding!"

Phrasal Verbs:

- "run into" – to meet someone by chance
- "show up" – to arrive or appear
- "break down" – to stop working (e.g. a car)
- "freak out" – to become very emotional
- "find out" – to discover something

Colloquial Expressions:

- "No way!"
- "For real?"
- "That's nuts!"
- "I was like…"
- "Cracked me up."

Mini Dialogue:
A: You won't believe what happened at the airport.
B: What happened?
A: So there I was, rushing to the gate, and suddenly my shoe broke!

Speaking Task: Tell a funny or embarrassing personal story.
Fluency Challenge: Story swap — retell your partner's story.

 **Unit 5: Expressing Nuanced Opinions**

Goal: Discuss complex topics using polite disagreement and advanced expressions.

Sentence Patterns:

- "While it's true that…, I still believe…"
- "There's some truth to that, but…"
- "I'd argue that…"
- "It's a bit more complicated than that."
- "Let's look at it another way."

Key Expressions:

- "I see where you're coming from, but…"
- "Let's agree to disagree."
- "That's a valid point, however…"
- "It's not that simple."
- "I can see both sides."

Phrasal Verbs:

- "stick with" – to continue with something
- "back down" – to concede in an argument
- "deal with" – to handle a situation
- "weigh in" – to give your opinion
- "bring about" – to cause or result in

Colloquial Expressions:

- "Hot take."
- "Let's be real."
- "No offense."
- "At the end of the day…"

- "Fair point."

Mini Dialogue:

A: Social media is making people more connected.

B: I see where you’re coming from, but it can also cause isolation.

A: True. Let’s agree to disagree on that one.

Speaking Task: Roundtable discussion: "Is AI improving or damaging communication?"

Fluency Challenge: Speak for 2 minutes on a complex issue, using3 connectors and 1 softener.

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Appendix A

Questionnaire

Respondents' Information:

a. Name (optional)_____

b. English Proficiency Level

- ☐ Level A1 (Beginner)
- ☐ Level A2 (Pre-Intermediate)
- ☐ Level B1 (Intermediate)
- ☐ Level B2 (Upper-Intermediate)
- ☐ Level C1 (Advanced)
- ☐ Level C2 (Mastery)

Directions: Below you will see series of statements about the extent that causes difficulty in your English speaking skills. Kindly read each statement and put a check mark in the box that most clearly indicates the degree of difficulties.

Legend:

Strongly Agree (SA)- the highest level of agreement

Agree (A)- one level of agreement

Disagree (DA)- one level of disagreement

Strongly Disagree (SA)- highest level of disagreement

Questions:	SA 4	A 3	DA 2	SD 1
1. English conversation is difficult because the grammar is weak and the sentence structure cannot be formed.				
2. English conversation is difficult because Korean and English have different word order.				
3. English conversation is difficult because I don't know the vocabulary I'm trying to speak.				
4. English conversation is difficult because I don't know the colloquial expression of English.				
5. English conversation is difficult because I am not confident in English pronunciation, stress, and intonation.				
6. English conversation is difficult because I can't understand what native speakers said.				
7. English conversation is difficult when native speakers don't understand what I'm saying.				
8. English conversation is difficult because the speed of speech is so fast.				
9. I feel the limit because I can't think of various topics when I speak English.				

10. The background knowledge of one particular topic is weak, so I can't talk long.				
11. English conversation is difficult due to lack of knowledge of English-speaking culture.				
12. I have a weak knowledge of the difference between Korean and English culture. I feel limited in English conversation.				
13. It is difficult to express in English after thinking in Korean.				
14. English conversation is difficult due to the difference in thinking between Koreans and native speakers.				
15. I have a lot of knowledge in my head, but it is difficult to use in different situations to construct and convey new expressions.				
16. Thinking a lot with excessive self-consciousness. I have difficulty expressing what I want to say outside.				
17. Because I have a more abstract way of thinking as an adult than as a child. It is an obstacle to English conversation.				
18. English conversation is difficult because of my timid personality.				
19. There is a limit to English conversation due to lack of bold attempts.				
20. Anxiety such as frustration, self-doubt, etc. hinder English conversation.				
21. My pride is so strong that it interferes with my English conversation.				
22. There is no progress in English conversation due to lack of motivation.				
23. There is a limit to English conversation due to lack of opportunities to talk to native speakers.				
24. When I meet a native speaker personally, I can speak well, but I can't speak well in class.				
25. I can speak English well with Korean teachers, but I can't speak English well with a native speaker.				
26. If there is a person who speaks well in one classroom, it shrinks and makes conversation difficult.				
27. I can't communicate well because I think my teacher evaluates my conversation skills.				
28. I can't communicate well because I think my friends are watching my conversation skills.				
29. It's hard to start talking because I'm not confident that I'll make an error.				

30. When I speak, the native speaker fixes it so often that it interferes with my conversation.				
31. Lack of time and economic leeway is an obstacle to conversation.				
32. The university entrance examination system and the exam-oriented school system are obstacles to conversation.				
33. I feel the limit because I can't speak English at a younger time.				

Appendix B

Questionnaire in Korean

이름 _____

영어 능력 수준

☐ Level A1 초보자

☐ Level A2 초중급

☐ Level B1 중급

☐ Level B2 중상급

☐ Level C1 고급

☐ Level C2 숙달

아래 각각의 요소들이 당신의 영어회화에 어려움을 초래하는 정도를 해당란에 체크하십시오.

o 4 매우 동의

o 3 다소 동의

o 2 다소 동의하지 않음

o 1 매우 동의하지 않음

질문	4	3	2	1
1. 문법이 약하여 문장구조를 형성하지 못하여 영어회화가 어렵다.				
2. 한국어와 영어가 어순이 달라서 영어회화가 어렵다.				
3. 말하려고 하는 어휘를 몰라서 영어회화가 어렵다.				
4. 영어의 구어적 표현을 몰라서 영어회화가 어렵다.				
5. 영어 발음이나 강세, 억양에 자신이 없어 영어회화가 어렵다.				
6. 원어민이 말한 것을 이해할 수 없어서 영어회화가 어렵다.				
7. 내가 하는 말을 원어민이 이해하지 못할 때 영어회화가 어렵다.				
8. 말의 속도가 너무 빨라서 영어회화가 어렵다.				
9. 영어 회화할 때 다양한 주제가 떠오르지 않아 한계를 느낀다.				
10. 특정한 하나의 주제에 대한 배경지식이 약하여 그 주제에 대해 길게 얘기하지 못한다.				
11. 영어권 문화에 대한 지식이 부족하여 영어회화가 어렵다.				

12. 한국과 영어권 문화내용의 차이점에 대한 지식이 약하여 영어회화에 한계를 느낀다.				
13. 한국어로 생각하고 난 후 영어로 표현하는 것이 어렵다.				
14. 한국인과 원어민의 사고관 차이로 인해 영어회화가 어렵다.				
15. 머릿속에 들어있는 지식은 많으나 상황마다 활용하여 새로운 표현을 구성하여 옮기는 것이 어렵다.				
16. 지나친 자아의식을 가지고 생각을 많이 하여 하고 싶은 말을 바깥으로 표출하는데 어려움이 있다.				
17. 유년기보다 성인이 되어 더 추상적 사고방식을 가지므로 영어회화에 장해요소가 된다.				
18. 소심한 성격으로 인해 영어회화가 어렵다.				
19. 과감한 시도가 부족하여 영어회화에 한계가 있다.				
20. 좌절감, 자기의심 등의 불안, 걱정이 영어회화에 저해가 된다.				
21. 자존심이 너무 강하여 영어회화에 방해가 된다.				
22. 동기가 부족하여 영어회화에 진전이 없다.				
23. 원어민과 대화할 기회가 부족해서 영어회화에 한계가 있다.				
24. 원어민을 개인적으로 만나면 회화가 잘 되나 수업때는 잘 안 된다.				
25. 한국인 선생님과는 영어회화가 잘 되지만 원어민과는 잘 안 된다.				
26. 한 교실에 말을 잘 하는 사람이 있으면 위축되어 회화가 잘 안된다.				
27. 선생님이 나의 회화실력을 평가한다고 생각하니 회화가 잘 안 된다.				
28. 친구들이 나의 회화실력을 지켜본다고 생각하니 회화가 잘 안된다.				
29. 오류를 범할까봐 자신이 없어 말을 시작하기가 어렵다.				
30. 말을 할 때 원어민이 너무 자주 고쳐줘서 회화에 방해가 된다.				
31. 시간적, 경제적 여유가 부족해서 회화에 장애요소가 된다.				

32. 대학 입시제도와 시험 중점의 학교제도가 회화에 저해요소가 된다.				
33. 좀더 어린 시기에 영어회화를 하지 못해서 한계를 느낀다.				

Appendix C

Consent Letter

September 11, 2024

Dear Sir/Ma'am:

Greetings!

The undersigned is a Master of Arts in English as a Second Language graduate school student from the University of the Cordilleras currently conducting a research "Inhibiting Factors in the Speaking Proficiency of Korean English Learners". The research aims to examine the level of inhibiting factors in the English Proficiency of Korean learners and its relationship with the learners' Oral proficiency levels. Since the identified respondents of this study are BESA learners, the researcher would like to ask permission to administer the questionnaire to your learners.

Attached is the questionnaire to be used in the research. Rest assured that all data will be treated with confidentiality and solely for this research purposes only. Your response regarding this matter is highly appreciated.

Respectfully,

Kristine S. Castillo

MA ESL Student

Appendix D

Descriptive Statistics

Descriptive Statistics

	N	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std. Deviation
Q1	58	1.00	4.00	2.79	.89
Q2	58	1.00	4.00	2.67	.96
Q3	57	1.00	4.00	3.11	.86
Q4	57	1.00	4.00	2.79	.84
Q5	58	1.00	4.00	2.24	.88
Q6	58	1.00	4.00	2.31	.96
Q7	58	1.00	4.00	2.26	.93
Q8	58	1.00	4.00	2.28	.93
Q9	58	1.00	4.00	2.47	.94
Q10	58	1.00	4.00	2.34	1.00
Q11	58	1.00	4.00	1.98	.76
Q12	58	1.00	4.00	2.02	.78
Q13	58	1.00	4.00	2.64	.83
Q14	58	1.00	4.00	1.79	.74
Q15	58	1.00	4.00	2.97	.75
Q16	58	1.00	4.00	2.21	.95
Q17	58	1.00	4.00	2.28	.89
Q18	58	1.00	4.00	1.72	.87
Q19	58	1.00	4.00	2.12	.94
Q20	57	1.00	4.00	1.82	.93
Q21	58	1.00	4.00	1.48	.71
Q22	58	1.00	4.00	1.67	.89
Q23	58	1.00	4.00	2.21	1.07
Q24	57	1.00	3.00	1.60	.65
Q25	58	1.00	4.00	1.69	.78
Q26	58	1.00	4.00	2.09	1.01
Q27	58	1.00	4.00	1.69	.73
Q28	58	1.00	4.00	1.91	.96
Q29	58	1.00	4.00	2.00	.97
Q30	58	1.00	3.00	1.33	.54
Q31	58	1.00	4.00	1.64	.77
Q32	58	1.00	4.00	2.57	1.09
Q33	58	1.00	4.00	2.83	1.06
Linguistic	58	1.38	3.75	2.55	.59
Schematic	58	1.00	3.25	2.20	.66
Cognitive	58	1.00	3.60	2.38	.57
Affective	58	1.00	4.00	1.76	.66
Interactional	58	1.00	3.64	1.96	.55
Valid N (listwise)	54				

Appendix E

SPSS Outputs

Directional Measures

			Value
Nominal by Interval	Eta	Profile Dependent	.688
		Linguistic Dependent	.461

Directional Measures

			Value
Nominal by Interval	Eta	Profile Dependent	.526
		Schematic Dependent	.234

Directional Measures

			Value
Nominal by Interval	Eta	Profile Dependent	.492
		Cognitive Dependent	.405

Directional Measures

			Value
Nominal by Interval	Eta	Profile Dependent	.576
		Affective Dependent	.334

Directional Measures

			Value
Nominal by Interval	Eta	Profile Dependent	.524
		Interactional Dependent	.420

Appendix F

Correlations

Correlations

		Profile	Linguistic	Schematic	Cognitive	Affective	Interactional
Profile	Pearson Correlation	1	-.404**	.033	-.318*	-.275*	-.239
	Sig. (2-tailed)		.002	.809	.015	.037	.071
	N	58	58	58	58	58	58
Linguistic	Pearson Correlation	-.404**	1	.181	.577**	.502**	.625**
	Sig. (2-tailed)	.002		.175	<.001	<.001	<.001
	N	58	58	58	58	58	58
Schematic	Pearson Correlation	.033	.181	1	.307*	.319*	.228
	Sig. (2-tailed)	.809	.175		.019	.015	.085
	N	58	58	58	58	58	58
Cognitive	Pearson Correlation	-.318*	.577**	.307*	1	.457**	.508**
	Sig. (2-tailed)	.015	<.001	.019		<.001	<.001
	N	58	58	58	58	58	58
Affective	Pearson Correlation	-.275*	.502**	.319*	.457**	1	.692**
	Sig. (2-tailed)	.037	<.001	.015	<.001		<.001
	N	58	58	58	58	58	58
Interactional	Pearson Correlation	-.239	.625**	.228	.508**	.692**	1
	Sig. (2-tailed)	.071	<.001	.085	<.001	<.001	
	N	58	58	58	58	58	58

**. Correlation is significant at the 0.01 level (2-tailed).

*. Correlation is significant at the 0.05 level (2-tailed).

CURRICULUM VITAE



KRISTINE SAN GABRIEL CASTILLO
E-mail: kscastillo@uc-bcf.edu.ph
+63945- 299 - 3544
Baguio City, Benguet

EDUCATIONAL ATTAINMENT

Graduate School
University of the Cordilleras
Master of Arts in English as a Second Language
2021 – Present (30 units earned)
Currently Enrolled in Thesis Writing 2

Tertiary
Baguio College of Technology (formerly BETI)
B.S Information Technology
#37 Harrison Road, Baguio City, (2010)

High School
Bayambang National High School
Bayambang Pangasinan, (2006)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

✓ **English Instructor (February 2023 – Present)**
University of the Cordilleras

✓ **Senior High School Substitute Teacher (August 2022 – October 2022)**
Baguio College of Technology

✓ **Dental Assistant (May 2016 – July 2017**
RAM Dental Hospital

✓ **ESL Teacher (April 29, 2013 – August 14, 2015)**
Pines International Academy

✓ **Production Planner** (March 2011 – May 2011)
Adriste Philippines Incorporated

✓ **Human Resource Training Coordinator (Trainer)**
(August 5, 2010 – April 2011)
Test Solution Services Incorporated

EDUCATIONAL ATTAINMENT/AWARDS

- Graduate of: B.S Information Technology
- Awarded as HONORABLE MENTION
- TRADE TEST PASSER: National Certificate (NC2) - PC Operation

(TESDA Accredited)
Certificate of Competency (COC)
Word Processing, Spreadsheet, Presentation Package, and Internet

- Received a Service Award for three and a half years for being Student Assistant at Baguio College of Technology (Assigned at Library and Inquiry Area)
- Completed the Program **"Train the Trainer"** as a requirement for Texas Instrument Subject Matter Expert
- Completed the Program "Teaching Empowerment Program for English Educators" (TEPEE)

PERSONAL DATA

- Date of Birth: September 25, 1989
- Place of Birth: Bautista, Pangasinan, Philippines
- Civil Status: Single
- Person to be contacted in case of emergency: Joan Castillo
- Contact Number: 09177375830

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PUBLISHING SERVICES

ABOUT THE AUTHOR



KRISTINE CASTILLO is an English Instructor at the University of the Cordilleras. She is passionate about teaching and guiding students to appreciate the value of using the English language in real-life communication and academic success. She enjoys teaching English to speakers of other languages of all ages. Aside from her work in the classroom, she continues to pursue personal growth and enjoys engaging in meaningful activities that inspire both her and her learners.

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